

Faith on Trial

by Martin Lloyd Jones

试炼中的信心

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Studies in Psalm 73

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诗篇七十三篇研经记录

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Chapter 1 The Problem Stated

Truly God is good to Israel, even to such as are of a clean heart.

But as for me, my feet were almost gone; my steps had well nigh slipped.

This man admits very freely that as for him his feet were almost gone, his steps had well-nigh slipped, 'all the day long have I been plagued, and chastened every morning.'

Now that was bad enough in itself. But that was not the thing that really troubled and distressed him. The real trouble was that when he looked at the ungodly he saw a striking contrast. 'These men,' he said, 'we all know to be ungodly—it is quite clear to everybody that they are ungodly. But they prosper in the world, they increase in riches, there are no bands — no pangs—in their death, but their strength is firm, they are not in trouble as other men.' He gives this description of them in their arrogance, their deceitfulness, their blasphemy. He gives us the most perfect picture in

一、问题的说明

「神实在恩待以色列那些清心的人。至于我，我的脚几乎失闪，我的脚险些滑跌。」（诗73:1-2）

诗人直率地承认他的脚几乎失闪，他的脚险些滑跌。「我终日遭灾难，每早晨受惩治。」（诗73:14）

事情本身糟透。但这并非困扰他和使他苦恼所在。真正的问题在于当他看着不敬虔之人时，他看见显著的落差。他说：「我们全都知他们不信神，人人都极清楚。但他们在世上兴隆，财富增加；死的时候没有疼痛，力气却也壮实，不像别人受苦，也不像别人遭灾。」（诗73:4-5）他说他们自大、虚假和褻渎，是所有文学巨著中所谓世上成功人士的最完美图画。他甚至描述其姿态，傲慢外

all literature of the so-called successful man of the world. He even describes his posture, his arrogant appearance, with his eyes standing out with fatness, and his pride compassing him about as a chain—a necklace. ‘Violence covers them as a garment,’ he says, ‘they have more than heart could wish’, ‘they speak loftily’—what a perfect description it is.

Moreover, not only was it true of people who lived at the time of the Psalmist, but you see the same kind of person today. They make blasphemous statements about God. They say, ‘How doth God know, and is there knowledge in the most High?’ You talk about your God, they say; we don’t believe in your God, yet look at us. Nothing goes wrong with us. But you, who are so godly, look at the things that happen to you! Now this was what caused this man his pain and his trouble. He believed God to be holy and righteous and true, One who intervenes on behalf of His people and surrounds them with loving care and wonderful promises. His problem was how to reconcile all this with what was happening to himself, and still more with what was happening to the ungodly.

型，「他们的眼睛，因体胖而凸出。」（诗73:7）他的「骄傲如链子戴在他们的项上。」他说：「强暴像衣裳遮住他们的身体。」（诗73:6）「他们所得的，过于心里所想的。」「他们说话自高。」（诗73:8）这描述分毫不差。

更且，不单止活在诗人那时候的人是这样，今天你看见的是同一类人。他们发出亵渎神的言词，他们说：「神怎能晓得？至高者岂有知识呢？」（诗73:11）你说到你的神，他们却说：「我们不相信你们的神，现在看看我们，我们没问题呢。但你这样敬虔的人，看看发生在你身上的事！」就是这个使这人痛苦和困惑。他相信神是神圣、公义和正确的，祂介入祂子民的事情，并以亲切的关怀和奇妙的应许围绕他们。他的问题是如何将这一切与所发生在他和在不信神之人身上的事情调和。

To be perplexed is the real message of this Psalm. It is all right up to a point, but as soon you get into this state of being perplexed, and you stop and dwell on it for a moment, at that moment temptation is at the door. It is ready to enter in, and before you know what has happened it will have entered in. And that is what had happened to this man.

Temptation can be so powerful that not only does it shake the greatest and strongest saint; it does, indeed, get him down. 'As for me,' says this man of God, 'as for me, my feet were almost gone; my steps had well nigh slipped.'

The Psalmist puts it like this—and notice that his wording is almost sarcasm at his own expense. Look at the third verse, 'For I was envious at the foolish.' He was envious of the arrogant. 'You know,' he seems to say, 'I hardly like to put it on paper, I am so heartily ashamed of it. But I have to confess that there was a moment when I, who have been so blessed of God, was envious of those ungodly people.' Only the blinding effect of temptation can explain that. It comes with such force that we are knocked off our balance, and are no

心里作难是本篇诗的真正信息。偶然心里作难没问题，一旦你进入作难状态，在此停留，长驻一会儿，那时试探已到门前了。它已准备好进来，在你知道甚么事情已然发生时，它必已进入。发生在这人身上的就是这事。

试探是可以强大到不单止摇动最伟大和最强壮的圣徒。这真的叫他跌倒。这人对神说：「至于我，至于我，我的脚几乎失闪，我的脚险些滑跌。」（诗73:2）

留心诗人所用的字眼几乎极尽讽刺的能事。看看诗73:3：「我见恶人和狂傲人享平安，就心怀不平。」他对傲慢的人心怀不平。他似乎说：「你知道我难以来书之纸上，我是这样完全为此感到羞耻。但我须承认有一刻这个曾这样蒙神赐福的我竟为那些不信神的人心怀不平。」惟有试探的弄瞎果效能解释这个。它的来到带着一个能力，把我们撞倒，不能再清晰地

longer able to think clearly.

Again, we must not forget the subtlety of Satan. He comes as a would-be friend. He had obviously come to the Psalmist like that. He said, 'Don't you think you are cleansing your heart in vain, and washing your hands in innocency?' Everything seems to be going wrong; you have been plagued 'all the day long', and 'chastened every morning'. One trouble follows hard after another. Now the one simple question I want to ask is this. Are you able to say in the face of it all, 'God is always good'? Yes, even in the face of what is happening to you, and even as you see the wicked flourish. In spite of the cruelty of an enemy or the treachery of a friend, in spite of all that is happening to you, can you say, 'God is always good; there is no exception; there is no qualification'? But let me remind you that while the Psalmist says, 'God is always good to Israel,' he is careful to add, 'Even to such as are of a clean heart.' Now we must be careful. We must be fair to ourselves; we must be fair to God. The promises of God are great, and all-inclusive. But they always have this condition, 'to them that are of a clean heart'. In other words, if you and I are sinning

思考。

我们也不可忘记撒但的狡猾。祂以朋友自居来到。明显地他曾这样临到诗人那里。他说：「我实在徒然洁净了我的心，徒然洗手表明无辜。」(诗73:13)似乎事事不顺利，你曾「终日遭灾难，每早晨受惩治。」(诗73:14)困难一个接一个。如今我想问的不过是简单的问题：你能否面对这一切时仍能说「神总是美善」？是的，就算面对发生在你身上的事情，就算你得见恶人昌盛，你能毫不理会敌人的残暴和朋友的背叛，不理会所发生在你身上的事下仍能说「神总是美善，没有例外，毫无保留」么？但让我提醒你，诗人是说「神总是恩待以色列的」，他小心地加上「那些清心的人」。这样我们定须小心。我们须对我们自己公平，我们须对神公平。神的应许伟大，包罗万有。但他们总附带条件，是给「那些清心的人」。换句话说，你和我若犯罪得罪神，那

against God, then God will have to deal with us, and it is going to be painful. But even when God chastises us He is still good to us. It is because He is good to us that He chastises us. If we do not experience chastisement, then we are 'bastards', as the author of the Epistle to the Hebrews reminds us. But, let us remember, if we want to see this clearly we must be of a clean heart. We must have 'truth in (our) inward parts', and there must be no hidden sin, because 'If I regard iniquity in my heart, the Lord will not hear me.' If I am not true and straight with God I have no right to appropriate any of the promises. If, on the other hand, it is my one desire to be right with Him, then I can say that it is absolutely the case that 'God is always good to Israel'.

I sometimes think that the very essence of the whole Christian position, and the secret of a successful spiritual life, is just to realize two things. They are in these first two verses, 'Truly God is good to Israel, even to such as are of a clean heart. But as for me, my feet were almost gone; my steps had well nigh slipped.' In other words, I must have complete, absolute confidence in God, and no confidence in myself. As long as you

么神必要对付我们，这会是痛苦的。就算神来管教我们，祂仍恩待我们。因着祂恩待我们才管教我们。我们若不经历管教，那么我们便是「私子」，如同希伯来书作者所提醒我们的。让我们谨记，我们若想清晰地看这个，我们定须要有一颗清心。我们定须里头有真理，必须没有隐藏的罪，因为「我若心里注重罪孽，主必不听。」（诗66:18）我若对神不真诚和正直，我便没有权来取用任何应许了。另一方面，我若是渴望与神相通无阻的话，那么我能说「神恩待以色列」是绝对的了。

有时我以为整个基督徒地位上的精髓和一个成功的属灵生命诀窍就只要明了两件事，都记载在这两节中：「神实在恩待以色列那些清心的人。至于我，我的脚几乎失闪，我的脚险些滑跌。」（诗73:1-2）换句话说，我必须完全绝对信靠神，却不信靠我自己。只要你一天都是站在「以灵来

and I are in the position in which we 'worship God in the Spirit, and rejoice in Christ Jesus, and have no confidence in the flesh' all is well with us.

Chapter 2 Getting a Foot-Hold

If I say, I will speak thus; behold, I should offend against the generation of thy children.

Here is a man suddenly tempted, tempted to say something, or, if you like, tempted to do something. The force of the temptation is so great that he is almost thrown off his balance. He is on the point of falling to the temptation, and he tells us what it was that saved him. Here it is, 'if I say.' 'If I say, I will speak thus; behold, I should offend against the generation of thy children.' What does he do? What is his method?

The first thing he does is to take himself in hand. He just kept himself from saying what was on the tip of his tongue. It was there, but he did not say it. The Psalmist realized the importance of never speaking hurriedly, of never speaking on an impulse. This man in Psalm 73 had discovered, even when he was on the point of falling, the importance of not saying anything in haste. It is wrong for

敬拜神，在基督耶稣里欢欣，不信靠肉体」的地位上，我们便安好。

二 得着一个立足点

「我若说：我要这样讲，这就是以奸诈待你的众子。」（诗73:15）

有人在这里偶然陷在试探中，在试探下说一些话，甚或在试探下作一些事。试探力度之大致使他几乎失去平衡。他来到陷入试探的转折点，他告诉我们甚么救了他。就是「我若说」。「我若说，我要这样讲，这就是以奸诈待你的众子。」（诗73:15）他作甚么？方法是甚么？

他作的第一件事就是勒住自己。他就是将去到嘴唇边的话按着不表，说话就在那里，但他没有说出来。诗人明白到不匆忙发言，不按冲动发言的重要性。在诗73篇的人就在他堕下的一刻发现到不急促发言的重要性。一个基督徒急促去说或作任何事都错误。你若想看

a Christian to say or do anything in haste. If you want it in its New Testament garb here it is from the Epistle of James, 'Be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath- (James 1:19. I must not elaborate on this here, but is it not obvious that if only we all implemented this particular principle then life would be much more harmonious? What a lot of trouble would be saved! What a lot of pin-pricks and irritations, what a lot of quarrelling and backbiting and unhappiness would be avoided in every realm of life, if only we all heeded this injunction! 'Be swift to hear, slow to speak'! Stop and think. If you can do nothing else, stop! Do not act o impulse.

So many of our troubles arise from the fact that we forget that causes lead to effects, and that these effect in turn lead to certain inevitable consequences. The devil traps us in his subtlety by seizing on what appears to be the isolated event. He puts that one thing before us in such a manner that we can see and think of nothing else. This one thing monopolizes our attention and the consequences are not considered. But this man saw the consequences. He said, 'if I say, I will

新约,就看雅各布的书信吧：「但你们各人要快快的听，**慢慢慢的说**，慢慢的动怒。」(雅1:19)我毋须在这详述,明显地只要我们实行这特特的原则,生命不就和諧得多么?免去的麻烦何等的多啊!在人生的每个范畴上何等多讨厌和烦琐的事、争吵、中伤和不快得以避免,只要我们全都留心「但你们各人要快快的听，慢慢的说！」这命令。停一停，想一想。你若没有别的可作，就停下来吧！不要凭冲动而行。

我们众多的麻烦都因我们忘记会带来之影响这事实所致,并且这些影响到头来引至无可避免的结果。魔鬼阴险地叫我们跌入陷阱中,狡猾地采用那些看来是独立的事件。他将这一件事呈现在我们眼前,以至我们不能看见和想到别的。这一件事独占我们的注意力,从不考虑后果。但这人看见后果,他说：「我若说

speak thus; behold, I should offend against the generation of thy children.' He was careful to consider the consequences, and to confront himself with them.

The Bible gives us many instances of this. One of the most glorious example of it, I think, is the case of that man Nehemiah. Nehemiah was in a position where his life was in jeopardy and a false 'friend' came to him and said, 'You are a very good man, and therefore you must no risk your life in the way you are doing—"in the night will they come to slay thee".' He suggested a proposal whereby Nehemiah should flee, and he put it in terms which sounded ingratiating and full of concern. If Nehemiah had listened to him the whole course of Israel's history would have been changed. The proposition must have appealed to him, but Nehemiah pulled himself up by saying, 'Should such a man as I flee?' He considered the consequences, and the moment he saw the consequences he did not do what was suggested. That is the thing that saved this man in Psalm 73. He saw the consequences and immediately he refrained.

The Psalmist is not sure about this

：我要这样讲，这就是以奸诈待祢的众子。」（诗73:15）他小心考虑到后果，自己勇敢地面对他们。

圣经给我们很多这样的例子，其中一个最好的事例，我想就是尼赫迈亚这人。尼赫迈亚所处的光景，就是他的生命陷入危险，一个虚假的「朋友」来到他处，说：「你是一个好人，因此你不该因着你行事的方法来叫你的生命冒险，『因为他们要来杀你，就是夜里来杀你。』」（尼6:10）他向尼赫迈亚作出逃命的提议，而他的托词听起来是奉承和满是关怀的。尼赫迈亚若听从他，那么以色列的整个历史便要改写。这建议必定讲与尼赫迈亚知，而尼赫迈亚却使自己停下来，说：「像我这样的人岂要逃跑呢？」（尼6:11）他想到后果，在他看见后果的一刻便不照所提议的去作。是这救了诗73篇这人，他看见后果，便立时悬崖勒马。

诗人不大确定神如

whole question of God's dealing with His children. That is still a matter of great perplexity. But he is very sure that it is wrong to be a stumbling-block or cause of offence to the generation of God's children. He is absolutely certain of that, and he acts upon it. You see the strategy. When you are uncertain and perplexed, the thing to do is to try to find something of which you are certain, and then take your stand on that. It may not be the central thing; that does not matter. This man saw the consequences of what he was about to do, and he knew for certain it was wrong. Therefore he said, 'I will not say it.' He is still not clear about the main trouble, but he is clear about that.

The first principle I would lay down for our special guidance is that our speech must always be essentially positive. The next principle is that truth is comprehensive and its various parts interrelated. I mean that there is no such thing as isolated truth. The next principle is that we must never forget our relationship to one another. The thing that held this man at first was not anything that he discovered about God's way with respect to himself but his recollection of his

何去处置祂儿女的整个问题，这仍是一件十分困惑的事件。但他却十分肯定成为一绊脚石或冒犯神的众子是错误的。他绝对肯定这个，因此这使他有所行动。你看见策略所在吧。当你不肯定和困惑时，要作的就是尽力去找出你肯定的，之后坚持。这也许不是重心所在，但不打紧。这人看见他将要作那事情的后果，也肯定知道这是错误的。因此他说：「我必不这样说。」他仍未弄清主要问题，但他清楚这是错误的。

我订定作为我们特别引导的首个原则就是我们的说话定必根本正面。第二个原则是这真理要详尽，其不同成分都要是互相关联。我是说根本没有个别真理这回事。下一个原则就是我们必须不可忘记我们跟别人的关系。他发现开初抓着这人的东西不是神处理他的方法，而是叫他回忆他与别人的关系。保罗以一

relationship to other people. The apostle Paul puts that in a striking verse in Romans 14. He says, 'None of us liveth to himself, and no man dieth to himself.' He goes on to elaborate it, and in doing so analyses the question of the weaker brother. He does the same in 1 Corinthians 8 and 10. He puts it like this in a most remarkable phrase, 'Conscience, I say, not thine own, but of the other' (10:29). In other words, you as a strong Christian must not decide this in terms of yourself. What about your weaker brother for whom Christ died? You must not offend his conscience. No man 'liveth unto himself'; we are all bound up together, and if you cannot check yourself for your own sake, you must check yourself because of your weaker brother.

The next principle is the importance of having certain absolutes in our life. In other words, we must learn to recognize that there are certain things that are quite unthinkable, and we must never do them. We should make it our business in life to list certain things that must never be done. We must never even consider them. I do not hesitate to assert that the appalling increase in

触目的经文来说到它：「我们没有一个人为自己活，也没有一个人为自己死。」（罗14:7）他继续详细说明，从而分析软弱弟兄的软弱所在。在林前8和10章他也作相同之事，他以一更引人注目的经节来说到它：「我说的良心，不是你的，乃是他的。」（林前10:29）换句话说，身为坚固基督徒的人一定不可为你自己来决定这事。那个主为他死的软弱弟兄又如何？你一定不可损害他的良心。没有人「为他自己活」，我们全都连系一起，你若不能为己自我审视的话，就须为软弱的弟兄自审了。

下一个原则就是**在我们生命中有着某些绝对真理的重要性**。换句话说，我们定须学会认识有些事情是完全想不来的，我们也必不可作他们。我们该列出某些我们永不作的事情为我们生命的本分。我们必须连想他们也不想。我毫不犹豫来坚决表明今时离婚过

divorce cases at the present time is simply due to the failure to realize this principle. I mean that when two people marry and take their solemn vows and pledges before God and before men they ought to be locking a certain back door that they should never even look at again. But that is not the way today. People seem to get married and to leave the back door, which leads to separate lives, open. They are looking backwards over their shoulder, and they often allow themselves to think of the possibility of breaking up the marriage before they have even made their vows. That is why life is as it is at the present time. People no longer have their absolutes.

The last principle is the importance of remembering who and what you are. In a sense I have already covered this. You and I are people who have been called by God out of this present evil world. We have been purchased at the cost of the shed blood of the only begotten Son of God on a cross on Calvary's hill, not merely that we may be forgiven and go to heaven, but that we may be delivered from all sin and iniquity, and that He may 'purify unto himself a peculiar people, zealous of good works' (2:14).

案增加的惨不忍睹不过是因为在明白这原则上的失败所致。我是说当二人结婚，在神和人面前发出他们严肃的誓词和诺言时，他们该锁上了那后门，之后永不再要回望。但今天并不是这样。人们就像结婚后任让「过着独立生活」的后门开启。他们从他们的肩头回望，他们常常甚至在他们作出誓言之前便容许自己想到离婚的可能性。就是这原因今时的生命弄成这个模样。人们不再有着他们绝对不可作的事情。

最后一个原则是谨记你是谁和你是甚么的重要性。某程度上我已说到这个。你和我是被神从现今罪恶世界中召出来的子民。我们曾被在加略山十架上神儿子流血的代价所买赎，不单止我们被饶恕和得以上天堂，并且我们得以从所有罪和过犯中蒙拯救，更且祂得以「洁净我们，特作自己的子民，热心为善。」(多 2:14) 祂已作成这个，这

He has done that, and that is our claim. I say, therefore, remember that, and whenever any perplexity arises or anything that tends to shake you, take it and put it in the light of that. Though you do not understand the thing itself, you must at that point say, 'I do not mind, I am content not to understand. All I know is that as a child of God, bought with the blood of Christ, there are certain things that I cannot do and this is one of them, and therefore I will not do it, and whatever the consequences are, I will stand firm.'

So long as you can find anything that will hold you, use it. Do not despise 'the day of small things'. Do not think that you are too spiritual to stand on such a low level. If you do, you will fall. Stand on any point you can. Stand even on a negative—I mean by that, that you may be capable of saying only, 'I could not do that.' Stand on that. For it comes to this, when your feet are slipping the one thing you need is to be able to stand. Stop slipping and sliding. Get your feet firm for a moment and take anything that offers itself for that purpose; stand on that and stay on that. We are engaged in spiritual mountaineering. The slopes are like

就是我的宣告。因此我说：当谨记无论甚么困惑出现时，或有任何事情似乎要动摇你时，用上这原则和将它放在光中。虽然你不明白事情本身，你在这定须说「我不介意，我乐于不明白。我所知的就是因着基督之血所买赎而作为神儿女的，有某些事情我是不能作的，这就是其中一样，因此我必不作这个，无论后果如何，我也会牢牢守着。」

运你能找到一些会支撑起你的东西。「谁藐视这日的事为小呢？」

(亚4:10)不要以为这地位于太属灵的你太低。若这样，你必会跌倒。站在你能站的任何地位，那怕如何不利，我是说，站稳在你能说「我不能作这个」那处。事情是这样，当你失足时，你唯一需作的是站牢，不再失足和滑跌。双足有一刻牢靠，接受任何能叫达至这目的的东西，在这站牢持守。我们正参与属灵的攀山，斜坡长满草，叫你滑进那可怖峡谷而失迷。因此你

glass, and you can slip into that terrible ravine and lose yourself. I say, therefore, that if you see anything, however small a twig, clutch at it, hold it, put your feet in the slightest hold, or on the narrowest ledge, anything to steady yourself and to enable you to stop for the moment. Once you have stopped the downward slipping and sliding you can begin to climb again.

It was because the Psalmist found that small foothold and planted his feet in it, that he stopped slipping. And from that moment he began the wonderful process of climbing again until eventually he found himself able to rejoice once more in the knowledge of God and to understand even the problem that had perplexed him, and to say, 'God is always good to Israel. What a fool I have been.'

Chapter 3 The Importance of Spiritual Thinking

When I thought to know this, it was too painful for me;

Until I went into the sanctuary of God; then understood I their end.

The whole trouble with Psalmist up till now was that he had been approaching his problem solely in

若得见任何东西，小至树枝，都紧抓它不放，叫你双足得最微细的支撑；又或者是最狭小的横撑，任何可叫你定身的东西，叫你能一刻停留的东西。你一旦停止了失足和下滑，你便能够再次往上爬了。

因着诗人发现这小小的落脚点，便将双足安放那儿，他下滑得以停止。从这刻开始，他再次开始那奇妙的复爬旅程，直至最后发现自己能够因认识神并连困扰他的问题也得以理解而再次欢欣，并说：「神总恩待以色列。我一直是多么愚蠢啊！」

三 属灵思想的重要性

「我思索怎能明白这事，眼看实系为难。等我进了神的圣所，思想他们的结局。」（诗73:16-17）

至今诗人的整个问题就是他只以他一己思想和他一己认知来面对

terms of his own thoughts and his own understanding. The first thing to do, therefore, is to stop this preoccupation with self and to stop turning round and round in circles on the natural level!

But how does one break out of the vicious circle? I suggest that there are three main things here. I would put first what this man puts first—literally going to the house of God. What a wonderful place God's house is. Often you will find deliverance by merely coming into it. Many a time have I thanked God for His house. I thank God that He has ordained that His people should meet together in companies, and worship together. The house of God has delivered me from 'the mumps and measles of the soul' a thousand times and more—merely to enter its doors. How does it work? I think it works like this. The very fact that there is a house of God to come to at all tells us something. How has it come into being? It is God who has planned and arranged it. To realize that in itself puts us immediately into a more healthy condition. Then we begin to go back through history, and remind ourselves of certain truths. Here am I at this present time with this terrible problem, but the Christian

他的问题。因此首先该作的事就是停止对己的全神贯注，停止在天然层面的圈中团团转！

但如何脱离这恶性的循环呢？在这我提议三件主要的事。我将这人排首位的放在首位。照字面来到神的居所。神的居所是一个何等美妙的地方。只要你进入便常找着救助。我多时为着神的居所来感谢祂，我感谢神的是因着祂命令神的子民聚在一起，一同敬拜。只因得进神居所的门，便使我不止千次从「生命的腮腺炎和麻疹」中得释放。这是如何作成的呢？我想是这样的。有神居所这事实告诉我们一件事。它是如何成为真实的？这是神所计划和安排的。明白这个本身立时将我们放进一更健康的状况。那么我们再次重回历史之处，并提醒我们某些真理。有着这可怕问题的我如今就在这里，但基督教会已存在经年。（我已开始以完全不同的方式来

Church has existed all these long years. (I am already beginning to think in an entirely different way.) The house of God goes back through the centuries to the time of our Lord Himself. What is it for? What is its significance? And the cure has begun.

Again, we go to the house of God, and to our amazement we find other people there before us. We are rather surprised at that, because in our private misery and perplexity we had come to the conclusion that perhaps there was nothing in religion at all, and that it was not worth continuing with it. But here are people who think it is worth continuing with; and we feel better. We begin to say: Perhaps I may be wrong; all these people think there is something in it; they may be right. The healing process is going on, the cure is being continued.

The second thing that helps us to think spiritually is the Bible. Now in the days of the Psalmist they did not have God's Word as you and I have it today. It is not only in the sanctuary, it is available everywhere. Turn to it in the home or in the church, it does not matter where, and it will immediately make you think spiritually. It does so in countless ways. One of the reasons

思想。)神的居所回到多世纪前我们主自己的年代。这居所是作何用的？它有何重要？医治已然开始。

我们再次来到神的居所，我们惊奇发现有人比我们先在那里。我们为此颇感惊奇，因为在我们一己的痛苦和困惑上，我们结论说或者信仰根本不存在，是不值得继续去信的。但这里的人以为这是值得继续的，因此我们感到好些。我们开始说：「也许我错了，这些人全都认为里头的是有价值的，他们可能是对的。那治疗过程继续，治愈正进行中。

第二样可帮助我们属灵思想的就是圣经。在诗人日子的人没有我们今天所有的神的话语。它不单止在圣所，每一处都有。在家中或在教会中翻阅它，无论在那里，它必然会立时使你有属灵的思想。它以无数方法来作这个。神给我们这话语

why God has given us this Word is in order to help us to deal with this problem that we are considering. Just a word on the other essential aid—prayer and meditation. That is what goes on in the sanctuary of God. The Psalmist did not merely go to the building, he went to meet God. The sanctuary is the place in which God's honour dwells, the meeting-place for God and His people. It is when we come face to face with God and meditate upon Him that we are finally delivered from that low level of rational thinking and begin again to think spiritually. I wonder whether there is someone who is surprised that I have not put prayer first, or at least before this. I am sure there are some, because I know a number of Christian people who have a universal answer to all questions. It does not matter what the question is, they always say, 'Pray about it.' If a man in the Psalmist's condition had come to any one of them they would have said, 'Go and pray about it.' What a glib, superficial and false bit of advice that can often be, and I am saying that from a Christian pulpit. You may ask, Is it ever wrong to tell men to make their problems a matter of prayer? It is never

其中一个原因就是帮助我们处理我们正想着的这问题。顺道说说另一个必要的帮助——祷告和默想。这是在神圣所中发生。诗人不单止进入建筑物，他去与神会面。圣所是神荣耀的居所，是神和祂子民见面之处。当我们与神面对面默想祂时，我们最终得从理性思想的低下阶段中得释放，开始再次有属灵的思想。我怀疑有否人因我没有将祷告排首位，或最少没有排前而感惊奇。我肯定有人这样，因为我认识一些返教会的人对所有问题都有万用答案。问题是甚么不打紧，他们总是说：「为这祷告吧。」若有在诗人状况的人来到他们其中一人时，他们会说：「来为此祈祷吧。」这是常能有的答案中何等未经思考、肤浅和错误的一小片劝告，我是在基督徒讲台上说这个。你也许会问，告诉一个人使他们的问题变成为一件祷告事项会否是错？这永不会错，但这有时是完全无

wrong, but it is sometimes quite futile. What I mean is this. The whole trouble with this poor man, in a sense, was that he was so muddled in his thinking about God that he could not pray to Him. If we have muddled thoughts in our mind and heart concerning God's way with respect to us, how can we pray? We cannot. Before we can pray truly we must think spiritually. There is nothing more fatuous than glib talk about prayer, as if prayer were something which you can always immediately rush into.

In case you doubt my word, let me quote one of the greatest men of prayer the world has ever known. I refer to the great George Muller of Bristol. George Muller, in lecturing to ministers, in particular, on this question of prayer, told them this. He said that for many years the first thing he did every morning of his life was to pray. He had now long since discovered that this was not the best way. He had found that in order to pray truly and spiritually, he had to be in the Spirit himself and that he must prepare himself first. He had discovered that it was good and most helpful, and he now strongly recommended it to them, always to

效，我的意思是，这可怜人的问题某程度来说在他想到神时是那样混乱，因而不会祷告神。我们若在意念和心中对神的道在我们身上有混乱的思想时，又怎能祷告？我们不能。我们能真诚祷告之先定须有属灵的思想。没有比随便论到祈祷更愚蠢，如同祈祷是一些你总能立时草率去作的东西一样。

你若质疑我的话，让我引述其中一个名闻天下最伟大人物的祷告。我说的是比利斯托的**乔治·慕勒**。他特在祷告这问题上向传道者传讲，向他们说到这个。多年来他生命的每早晨作的第一件事就是祷告。长时间过后的今天他才发现这不是最好的方法。他发现**为了要真诚和有属灵的祷告，他必须在圣灵里，并且他必须先预备好自己**。他发现到这是美好和最有帮助的，他如今强烈地向他们推介这个，在他们开始祷告总先要读一

read a portion of Scripture and perhaps some devotional book before they began to pray. In other words, he found it was necessary to put himself and his spirit right before he could truly pray to God.

Now that is exactly what happened to this Psalmist. He was in a vicious circle and, thinking as he did, he could not pray because his whole thinking was wrong. Now in the steps I have enumerated his thinking was put right, and then he was in the right condition to pray. Very often we waste our time thinking we are praying when we are not really praying at all. Often it is only some sort of crying out in desperation. Our whole mind is wrong and so is our attitude, and we cannot pray to God until we realize His presence, and we do not realize His presence until our thinking about Him is right. Paul said again to the Philippians, 'We are the circumcision, which worship God in the spirit, and rejoice in Christ Jesus, and have no confidence in the flesh' (Philippians 3:3). We must pray 'in the Spirit'. We must be spiritually prepared, and that means that our thinking is straight and true. So the steps are perfectly right—the house of God, the Word of

段圣经，也许加上一些灵修读物。换句话说，他发现到在他能对神真诚地祷告之先，他必须使自己和他的灵正直。

发生在诗人身上的正是这个。他陷在恶性循环中，想到他的现状，他不能祈祷，因为整个思想错误。照我所列举的阶段，如今他思想已校正，来到祷告的正确状态。我们多时浪费时间，以为我们是祷告，其实完全不是。有时只是一些渴求的某类呼叫。我们的整个心思错误，态度亦一样，我们不能祷告神，除非我们意识到祂的同在。我们不会意识到祂同在，除非我们对祂的思想正确。保罗对腓立比人说：「因为真受割礼的，乃是我们这以神的灵敬拜，在基督耶稣里夸口，不靠着肉体的。」（腓3:3）我们定须「以神的灵」来祷告。我们定须心灵上预备好，思想是正直正确。因此完全正确的步骤是：神的居所、神的道、向神祷告和与神相

God, prayer to God and communion with God. 交。

Thus, having realized that all those other thoughts were blasphemous and wrong, when our spirit is cleansed and bathed, we turn to God and we face Him, and our spirit finds rest. That is the process, or, rather, that is the beginning. We have not finished yet, but having got a foothold, that is how the process continues. In trouble, 'until I went into the sanctuary of God'—and found myself face to face with Him.

Chapter IV Facing all the Facts

When I thought to know this, it was too painful for me;

Until I went into the sanctuary of God; then understood I their end.

The first word we have to deal with is this word 'understood'. This is, again, one of those great fundamental principles of our faith which we can so easily forget. What we find in the sanctuary of God is not merely a general influence, not merely a matter of atmosphere. When this man went into the sanctuary of God he was given *understanding*. He did not merely feel better; he was put right in his thinking.

因此，当明白到这一切其它的思想是褻渎和错误，当我们的灵得洁净和洗涤时，我们转向神，且面对祂，我们的灵是这样找到安息。这是那过程，甚或是开端。我们还未完成，不过有叫过程可继续的一个立足点。当遇上麻烦，「等我进了神的圣所」，发现自己与神面对面。

四 面对所有事实

「我思索怎能明白这事，眼看实系为难。等我进了神的圣所，思想他们的结局。」（诗 73:16-17）

我们要处理的第一个词语就是「明白」。这也是我们信心上极易忘记重大基本原则之一。我们在神圣所中所找到的东西不单止是一普遍的影响，不单止是一氛围的问题。当这人进入神圣所时，他得赐「明白」。他不单止感觉良好，他且在思想中被校正。他不单止

He did not merely forget his problem for the time being; he found a solution.

That is what a man sees when he come into the sanctuary of God. He begins to see things as a whole, he is reminded of things he had forgotten and ignored. The apostle Paul put this in a marvellous phrase. There was a time when he hated the Name of Jesus of Nazareth and he persecuted His people. He thought he was doing God service by killing Christian people. But when he saw Him and came to know Him, everything became new, and looking back on his old life he said, 'I verily thought with myself, that I ought to do many things contrary to the name of Jesus of Nazareth' (Acts 26:9). Precisely. He thought 'with himself.' As long as you and I think with ourselves we shall never see life truly.

Now look at Christ. Look at His life, look at the record of what He has done. Stand before the cross, face it and try to explain it. Then look at the story of the Church and the martyrs and the saints. Take it all in. Do not be content with anything less than all. Then rise to the ultimate height, and stand before God. Lack of the true thinking is our ultimate trouble, for if

一时忘记他的问题，他且找到答案。

这是当人来到神的圣所时所看见的东西。他开始以整体来看事物，所提醒他的是他已忘记和忽略的东西。使徒保罗将这写成绝妙的一句。从前他是恨恶拿撒勒人耶稣的名，他也逼害祂的子民。他以为他杀害基督徒就是服事神。但当他看见祂时，得以认识祂，一切变成为新。当回望他旧有生命时他说：「从前我自己以为应当多方攻击拿撒勒人耶稣的名。」（徒26:9）他自己以为这说法确切。只要你我自我以为时便不会见到真实的生命了。

如今看看基督、祂的生命、祂行事的记录。站在十字架前面对它和尝试解释它。之后看看教会、殉道者和圣徒的故事。全都取来看。不要满意任何不及这一切的东西。之后来到最高处，站在神面前。缺乏真正的思想是我们终极的问题，我

we do not think of all the aspects and phases, if we do not face all the facts, we shall inevitably go astray. If, therefore, you feel that you have a grudge against life and against God and you are feeling sorry for yourself, I have but one word to say to you. Hasten to the sanctuary; consider all the facts; remember the things you have forgotten.

That is a great theme in the Bible. James has a great word to say about the case of Job. He says, 'Ye have heard of the patience of Job, and have seen the end of the Lord' (James 5:11). Job had been having a hard time, and he could not understand what was the matter. He had not thought on to 'the end' of the Lord. The end of the story in the last chapter of Job is that Job, who had been bereft of everything, ended by having much more than he had before. That is 'the end' of the Lord. Go on to the end. Do not stop short. Is that not the argument of Psalm 37? What the Psalmist says there is that he had seen the wicked in great power and spreading himself like a green bay-tree, but when the end came he had vanished off the face of the earth, and no-one could find him. So he says, 'Mark the perfect man, and

们若不顾及所有层面和阶段,若不面对所有的事实,必无可避免走迷。因此你若感到对生命和对神有嫌隙,你且为自己感到难过时,我对你只有一话可说。快快到圣所去,想想所有的事实,记取你已忘记的东西。

这是教会的重大题目。雅各布在乔布的事例上有话说:「你们听说过乔布的忍耐,也知道主给他的结局。」(雅5:11)乔布有艰难的时刻,他不明白发生了甚么事。他没有想到主给他的结局。故事的结局是在乔布记末章中,曾在各事上失落的乔布,最终得的比从前得的还要多。这就是主给他的结局。不要突然停止。这不是诗37篇的论点么?诗人在那里说的是他「见过恶人大有势力,好像一根青翠树在本土生发。」(诗37:35)但结局时他没有了,从地面上消失,无人能寻到他。因此他说:「你要细察那完全人,观看哪正直人,

behold the upright: for the end of that man is peace' (verse 37). The importance of 'the end' is something which is constantly emphasized in the Bible.

Our Lord has put it once and for ever in the Sermon on the Mount. 'Enter ye in at the strait gate: for wide is the gate, and broad is the way, that leadeth to destruction, and many there be which go in thereat: because strait is the gate, and narrow is the way, which leadeth unto life, and few there be that find it.' You see what He is saying. Look at the broad way, how marvelous it seems. You can go in with the crowd, you can do what everybody else is doing, and they are all smiling and joking. Wide and broad are the gate and the way. It all seems so marvelous. And this other seems so miserable—'strait is the gate'. One at a time, a personal decision, fighting self, taking up the cross. 'Strait is the gate, and narrow is the way.' And it is because they look only at the beginning that so many people are on the broad way. What is the matter with them? They do not look at the end. 'Wide is the gate, and broad is the way, that leadeth to destruction.' 'Strait is the gate, and narrow is the

因为和平人有好结局。」
(诗37:35) 「结局」的重要性是圣经中常常强调的。

我们的主在登山宝训上曾彻底地说到「你们要进窄门，因为引到灭亡，那门是宽的，路是大的，进去的人也多。引到永生，那门是窄的，路是小的，找着的人也少。」
(太7:13-14) 你明白祂所说的。看看那大路，看来何等奇妙。你能戴着冠冕进入，你能作任何人作的，他们全也会微笑和开玩笑。宽和广的是门和路。这一切看来都那样奇妙。而另一个看来是那么卑劣——门是窄的。每次一人，是个人的决定，与自己搏斗，背起十字架。「门是窄的，路是小的」。因着他们只看着开端，那么多人是在大路上。他们发生了甚么事？他们没有看见结局。「引到灭亡，那门是宽的，路是大的。」
「引到永生，那门是窄的，路是小的。」

way', but—and that is the end—it 'leadeth unto life'.

The Bible everywhere urges us to consider our 'latter end'. Do not go to church merely to consider your present prospects; consider your latter end. 'The end.' How glorious it would be for all of us to be able to face it as the apostle Paul did, and to be able to say, 'Henceforth there is laid up for me a crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous judge, shall give me at that day.' The way to be able to say that, and to be certain that you will receive that crown, is first to look at the two possibilities as a whole, and having done so, to go immediately to God and confess your blindness, your prejudice, your folly in trusting to your own understanding, and then to ask Him to receive you. Tell Him you accept His message concerning Jesus Christ His only begotten Son, who came into the world to die for your sins and to deliver you. Yield yourself to Him and rely upon Him and His power. Give yourself unreservedly to Him in Christ and you will see life with a wholeness and a blessedness you have never known before. And the end will be glorious. Your path will be as the shining light that shineth more and

圣经到处催促我们想到「后来的结局」。返教会不只想到现今的形势，也要想到后来的「结局」。于我们所有人能够像使徒保罗般面对结局，能够说「从此以后，有公义的冠冕为我存留，就是按着公义审判的主到了那日要赐给我的」是何等的荣耀。肯定你必会得着那冠冕的方法是先去整体来看看那两个可能性，你若这样作，便立时去到神处来承认你的眼瞎，你的偏见，你在信靠一己理解力上的愚蠢，之后求祂来收纳你。告诉祂你接受那个论到祂独生爱子耶稣基督的信息，祂来到世上为你的罪死和使你得释放。把你自已降服于祂，倚靠祂和祂的能力。将你自己毫无保留地给与在基督里的祂，必得见生命的完整和蒙恩，是之先从未认识过的。那结局必是荣耀的。道途必会如同日光，越照越明。世界变得如何黑暗，就算经过

more, however black the world may become and, even in the shadow of death, it will shine more and more unto the perfect day. 'Then understood I their end.'

Chapter 5 Beginning to Understand

Surely thou didst set them in slippery places: thou castedst them down into destruction.

How are they brought into desolation, as in a moment!

they are utterly consumed with terrors. As a dream when one awaketh; so, O Lord, when thou awakes, thou shalt despise their image.

We have seen the Psalmist's thinking put right in general.

What, then, is the teaching of the Bible in this respect: The first thing we find is that it gives us actual history. We cannot remind ourselves too frequently of stories such as those of the Flood, of Sodom and Gomorrah, the Philistines, Assyrians, Babylonians and Belshazzar. They all teach the same lesson, of God's triumph over His enemies. But towering above them all is the great fact of the resurrection which shows God triumphing finally over the devil and all his powers. The continuing victory is seen everywhere

死荫的幽谷，必会越照越明，直至那完美的一日。「等我思想他们的结局。」

五 开始明白

「祢实在把他们安在滑地，使他们掉在沉沦之中。他们转眼之间，成了何等的荒凉。他们被惊恐灭尽了。人睡醒了怎样看梦，主阿，祢醒了，也必照样轻看他们的影像。（诗73:18-20）」

我们已得见诗人思想上大体上的归正。

那么圣经这方面的教训就是：我们发现的第一件事就是它给我们真实的历史。我们不能太常叫我们想到如那些洪水、所多玛和蛾摩拉、非利士人、亚述人、巴比伦人和伯沙撒等故事。他们都有着相同的教训，就是神得胜祂的仇敌。但高高屹立在他们一切以上的是复活这伟大事实，表明神最终对魔鬼和他一切政权的得胜。持续的胜利

in the Acts of the Apostles, and a grand view of the end is given in the book of Revelation.

The actual history of the Christian Church since the days of the apostles continues the same story. We know what has happened to all powers such as the Jews, Romans, etc., that have attempted to exterminate the Christian Church. We also know the epic stories of the martyrs and early confessors, the Waldensian Church, the early Protestants, the Puritans and the Covenanters. Indeed, this very century in which we live has provided us with yet further evidence.

The Bible, however, does not merely record history. It helps us to understand the meaning of history. It teaches certain principles very clearly. The first is that all things, even the evil powers, are under God's hand. As the Psalmist puts it here in verse 18, 'Surely thou didst set them in slippery places.' They are not free agents. Nothing happens apart from God. 'The Lord reigneth.' 'By me kings reign.' It is of vital importance that we should grasp the biblical doctrine of Providence. It can be defined as, 'That continued exercise of the divine energy whereby the Creator upholds all His

在使徒行传处处可见，在启示录也得赐下那结局的宏伟景观。

自使徒的日子起，教会的真正历史都持续着相同的故事。我们知道发生在例如犹大、罗马等政权的事，他们都尝试消灭教会。我们也知道殉道士和早期信徒、威尔登教会、早期抗罗宗、清教徒和结盟者的史诗式故事。就是我们如今活着的世纪也曾提我们进一步的证据。

圣经不单记录历史，它帮助我们明白历史的意义。它清晰教导某些原则。首个原则是包括邪恶势力的万物也服应神的手下。如诗人所说：「祢实在把他们安在滑地。」（诗73:18）他们并非自然发生。没有事物在神以外发生。「耶和华作王。」「帝王藉我坐国位。」（箴8:15）牢牢抓紧圣经在神旨意上的教义极为重要。这可定义为「创造者以持续运行的神圣力量托住一切被造物，遍布世上运

creatures, is operative in all that transpires in the world, and directs all things to their appointed end.' God is over all, and as we read in Psalm 76:10, 'Surely the wrath of man shall praise thee: the remainder of wrath shalt thou restrain.' In connection with this we have to remember God's permissive will. It is beyond our understanding, but it is clearly taught that He permits certain things to happen for His own purposes.

Another thing we see clearly here is that the whole position of the ungodly is precarious and dangerous. They are in 'slippery places'. All they have is but temporary. The Psalmist suddenly saw clearly what Moses saw when he chose 'rather to suffer affliction with the people of God, than to enjoy the pleasures of sin for a season'. Age and decay, death and judgment, are certain. The most terrible thing about sin is that it blinds men to the realization of this. They do not see that their pomp and glory is but for a season. 'The Lord reigneth; let the people tremble.'

The Psalmist saw this so clearly in the sanctuary of God that he not only ceased to be envious of the ungodly, but we get the impression that he even

行，也将万事万物导往所命定的结局。」当我们读到「人的忿怒，要成全祢的荣美；人的余怒，祢要禁止。」（诗76:10）时便得知神超乎一切之上。就此我们当谨记神容许的旨意。这超越我们的理解，但它明显教导说为着祂一己的旨意下祂容许某些事情发生。

另一个我们在这里清晰得见的是不信的人的整个地位是不安定和危险的。他们身在「滑地」。他们所有的是暂时的，诗人突然清晰得见摩西所见，他选择「宁可和神的百姓同受苦害，也不愿暂时享受罪中之乐。」（来11:25）年老衰败，死亡和审判是肯定的。罪叫人在这些事上眼瞎最可怖。他们看不见华丽和荣耀不过是暂时的，「耶和华作王，万民当战抖。」（诗99:1）

诗人在神的圣所中清晰地看见这个，因此他不再嫉妒不敬虔的人，但我们得的印象是当他明

began to feel sorry for them as he realized the truth about their position. Thus, his thinking with respect to the ungodly was put right, and there is perhaps no better test of our own profession of the Christian faith than just this. Do we feel sorry for the ungodly in their blindness? Have we even a sense of compassion for them as we see them as sheep without a shepherd?

What was it that was adjusted when he began thinking truly about God? I think the first thing was his attitude to the character of God; because, after all, what this man had been beginning to doubt was the very character of God Himself. Many of these Psalmists with strange and remarkable honesty confess that they were tempted along that line. For instance, in Psalm 77 the same thing is clearly expressed. The Psalmist asks, 'Will the Lord cast off for ever? and will he be favourable no more? Is his mercy clean gone for ever? doth his promise fail for evermore? Had God forgotten to be gracious? ...' That is the type of question they were asking, and, as I pointed out at the very beginning, some of the greatest saints have sometimes been tempted to ask

白到他们地位上的真相时，他甚至开始为他们感到难过。因此他在关乎到不敬虔之人的思想被校正，也许在我们一己基督信仰的承认上没有比这个试验更佳。我们为着不信之人的眼瞎有否感到难过？当我们得见他们如同无牧之羊时我们有否同情的感觉？

当他开始正确地想到神时，甚么被校正了？我想第一件是他对神品格上的态度，始终这人打从一开始所疑惑的就是神自己的品格。很多这样有着奇怪却出众诚实的诗人承认他们一直被试探。例如，在诗77篇中所清楚记述的是那相同的事情。诗人问：「难道主要永远丢弃我，不再施恩么？难道祂的慈爱永远穷尽……难道神忘记开恩……？」

（诗77:7-9）这类是他们询问的问题，并且正如我在一开始就指出，有一些伟大的圣徒当事情与他们意愿相违背时，他们有时也被试探来问这些问题。这样，这人以相同的

these questions when things had gone against them. Well, this man in the same way had been asking these same questions: Does God care, and if He does care why does He not stop these things? Is it that He cannot? And so doubts about the character of God lead to doubts about His power.

How often people have asked these questions! How often did people say in the last World War: Why does God permit a man like Hitler to live? If He is God and is all-powerful why doesn't He strike him down? The question then suggests itself: Is God perhaps unable to do it? Or: Have we been mistaken in our ideas about God? Have we been wrong in our ideas about His mercy and compassion and goodness? Why does He not demolish these people who are opposed to Him and His people? Those are the questions that tend to agitate our minds in times of trial.

Now this man had been assailed by just such questions; and here, now, he finds his answer. At once he is put right by remembering the greatness and the power of God—'thou didst set them in slippery places'. There is nothing outside the control of God. Many of the Psalms express this, as for

方法来问这些相同的问题：神矣顾么？祂若矣顾，为何祂不停止这些事情？是否祂不能够呢？这样对神品格的质疑引对祂能力的质疑。

人们多么经常问这些问题！在对上的一次世界大战上人多么经常说：为何神容许像希特勒这样的人存活？若祂是神，是全能的，为何不击倒他？其实问题中已有答案：是否神也许不能这样作？是否也许我们在神的观念上出错？在祂的怜悯、同情和美善的观念上是否出错？为何祂不去毁坏那些反对祂和祂子民的人？在试炼时刻中就是这些问题趋向于搅动我们的心思。

这人曾被这样的问题质问，如今他找到了答案。他是凭着记取神的伟大和能力来立时得校正：祂实在把他们安在滑地。没有东西在神掌管之外。很多诗人也说到这个，诗50篇就是一个例

example Psalm 50. It is, indeed, one of the great themes of the Bible. There is no limit to the power of God. He is eternal in all His powers and in all His attributes. 'He spake, and it was done.' He created everything out of nothing; He suspends the universe in space. Real certain great chapter of the book of Job (chapter 28, for example) and you will find it expressed in a most amazing manner.

'In the beginning God.' This is a fundamental postulate; the Bible asserts it everywhere. Whatever the explanation may be of all that is happening in the world, it is not that God is not capable stopping it. It is not that He cannot arrest these things, because the power of God, by definition, is illimitable. He is absolute; He is everlasting, eternal God to whom everything on earth is but as nothing. He owns everything; He governs, He controls everything; all things are under His hands. 'The Lord reigneth.' Now that is the first thing about which this man was put right, and that very clearly.

But, in the second place, he was also put right on the question of the righteousness and justice of God. That is the order in which these things arise.

子。这是圣经中其中一个伟大题目。神的能力没有限度。祂在一切的权能和属性上是永恒的。「神说.....事就这样成了。」(创1:9) 祂从无有中创造万有; 祂将宇宙悬在太空之中。在真实确定的伟大乔布记篇章(例如伯28章)中你必能找到最奇异方式的记述。

「起初神创造天地。」这是一根本的先决条件, 圣经到处都这样主张。无论如何解释在世上所发生的一切事, 都不是说神不能停止这个。神不是不能阻止这些事情, 因为按定义, 神的能力是没有限制的。祂是绝对的, 祂是永恒的, 地上的万事万物于永恒的神是为无物。万物都属祂, 祂统管万有, 祂支配一切, 万物都是在祂手下。「耶和华作王。」这是那人首先校正之事, 且十分清楚。

在第二处, 他在神的公义和公正的问题上也被校正。这些事情的出现也按这条理。神若有其权

If God has the power, why does He not exercise it? If God has the ability to destroy all His enemies, why does He allow them to do the things they do? Why are the ungodly allowed to flourish? What about the justice and righteousness of God? The answer is given in the words of Abraham of old, 'Shall not the Judge of all the earth do right?' (Genesis 18:25). It is as fundamental a postulate as that concerning the greatness and the might and the majesty of God, God is eternally just and right. God cannot change. God cannot (I say it with reverence, it is a part of the truth concerning the holiness of God)—God cannot be unjust. It is impossible.

James puts it like this: 'Let no man say when he is tempted, I am tempted of God: for God cannot be tempted with evil, neither tempteth he any man.' He is 'the Father of lights, with whom is no variableness, neither shadow of turning' (James 1:13, 17). If it were possible for any change or modification to take place in God He would no longer be God. God, as He has revealed to us about Himself, is, from everlasting to everlasting, always, ever the same; never any difference, never any modification. So Abraham is

柄，为何祂不行使它？神若有能力来摧毁所有祂的仇敌，那为甚么祂容许他们作他们作的事？为何不信的人这样兴盛？神的公正和公义怎么了？年长亚伯拉罕的说话提供了答案：「审判全地的主岂不行公义么？」（创18:25）这与关乎到神的伟大、大能和尊荣的先决条件同样基本，神永远公正和公义。神不能改变。我敬虔地说，这关乎到神圣洁之真理的一部分，神不能不公义，这没有可能。

雅各布这样说：「人被试探，不可说我是被神试探。因为神不能被恶试探，祂也不试探人。（祂是）众光之父。在祂并没有改变，也没有转动的影儿。」（雅1:13, 17）若任何改动和修正可能发生在神身上的话，祂便不再是神了。正如祂自己向我们启示的，自亘古到永远，祂总不变，永不会不同，没有任何修正。因此当亚伯拉罕说「审判全地

obviously right when he says, 'Shall not the Judge of all the earth do right?' He can do no other. We must realize this, so that, when we are tempted of the devil, or by our own predicament, or by any position which the devil may use, to query the righteousness of God, we may understand that what we are really doing is to imply that it is possible for God to vary and to change. But that is impossible. He cannot, because God is God, and, because of what He is, there can never be any variation in His justice or righteousness, there can never be any question of injustice or unrighteousness.

'Nevertheless I am continually with thee: thou hast holden me by my right hand. Thou shalt guide me with thy counsel, and afterward receive me to glory.' He sees it all, and so clearly that when he came to write his Psalm he began by saying, 'Truly God is good to Israel'—even when every appearance is to the contrary, God is always good to Israel, He never breaks a promise. These are what we must always regard as fundamental postulates in all our relationships to God, and we must never be tempted to question or query anything along

的主，岂不行公义么？」（创18:25）时明显是对的。祂不能作别的。因此我们定须明白这个，当我们因着一己的窘境或是因着魔鬼利用的地位而被试探来质疑神的公义，我们也许明白到我们所真正作的是意味着神有可能改动和改变。但这没有可能。祂不能，因为神就是神，并且因着神就是神，因此在祂公正和公义上永不会有任何改动，永不会有任何不公正和不公义的质疑。

「然而我常与祢同在。祢搀着我的右手。祢要以祢的训言引导我，以后必接我到荣耀里。」（诗73:23-24）当他写这首诗篇时，他得见这一切，且那么清晰，便说：「神实在恩待以色列。」虽然每个外在情况都相反，但神总是恩待以色列，祂永不会不履行应许。我们必须以这些作为我们与神所有关系上的基本假设，也永不要在这特定立场的任何事上被试探来发问或

that particular line.

The Psalmist says that the explanation is that God for the time being seems to be asleep. 'When thou awakes, thou shalt despise their image,' he says in verse 20. Now that is an anthropomorphism.

A similar statement is found in the next Psalm in verse 22, where, having described the desolation of the Church and the way in which the enemy has come in and has reduced it almost to a shambles, the Psalmist ends with a prayer. He says, 'Arise, O God, plead thine own cause...' It seems as if he turns to God and says, 'God, why don't You awake? Arise, O God...' It is the same idea. In Psalm 44:23 it is ever more explicit: 'Awake, why sleepest thou, O Lord? arise, cast us not off for ever.' Here is a man in desperation. He sees the desolation produced by the enemy; he sees the success of the ungodly and the suffering of the godly. He knows that God is just and all-powerful, so, turning to God, he says, 'Awake, why sleepest thou, O Lord?' Why do You not assert Yourself?

That is one reason. But it is not the only reason; for there is no doubt but that God permits this kind of thing

质疑。

诗人的答案是神似乎一时是睡着觉。在诗73:20中他说：「人睡醒了怎样看梦，主阿，祢醒了，也必照样轻看他们的影像。」这就是人格化。

在诗74:22也找到相同的字句，说到教会的荒凉，和敌人已进来，把教会几乎陷入混乱。诗人以祷告来结束：「神阿，求祢起来，为自己伸诉。」就如同他转向神说：「神啊，祢为何不睡醒呢？神啊，起来啊.....」这意念是相同的。在诗44:23便更清楚明白：「主阿，求祢睡醒，为何尽睡呢？求祢兴起，不要永远丢弃我们。」这里说到一个绝望的人。他得见敌人造成荒凉，不信神之人的成功，和信神之人的受苦。他知道神是公正和全能的，因此他转向神，说：「主啊，起来，为何祢要睡觉呢？」为何祢不维护自己呢？

原因只得一个，但不是唯一的原因，毫无疑问神容许这类的事情发生

also partly as the punishment of sin. If you read Romans 1, you will find that this point comes out there also. In other words, God withdraws His restraining power sometimes in order that people may reap some of the consequences of their own sins, and thereby He punishes them. We are all one by nature in that we want the pleasure of sin without the consequences; we desire to be able to sin and not to suffer for it. But we cannot, for, 'There is no peace, saith my God, to the wicked.' God has so made man, and for that reason we shall suffer, and sometimes God allows the world to get into a state of godlessness as part of its punishment. I do not hesitate to assert that that is the only real explanation of the two world wars. It is, in part, God meting out punishment to mankind for all its defiance of Him during the last hundred years. God allows things to develop in order that mankind may reap the consequences of that which it has sown. If we 'sow the wind' we may well 'reap the whirlwind'. And we have experienced that in our own life-time.

What is the next thing? I believe that God allows the evil and the evil-doers to have their fling; He allows

部分原因是因着要惩罚罪。你若读罗1章，必会发现那处也记有这点。换句话说，神撤回祂约束的能力有时是为了人们得以承受他们一己之罪的一些后果，祂这样惩罚他们。我们全都性情一样，想在没有后果下享受罪中之乐。我们渴望犯罪而不用因此而受苦。我们不能这样，因「我的神说：恶人必不得平安。」（赛57:21）神让人这样，来叫我们受苦，有时神容许世人来进入不信神的状态作为他们惩罚的一部分。我毫不犹豫来坚持这是两次世界大战的真正原因。这是因着人类在过去几百年蔑视神所派定的惩罚的部分原因，神容许事情这样发展为的是人类因而收割他们所播种的后果，我们「所种的是风，所收的是暴风。」（何8:7）在我们一生中也曾经历这过。

下一样是甚么？我相信神容许罪恶和恶人是为了任让他们。祂容让

them rope, licence, as it were, in order to make their overthrow more complete and sure. Biblical history is really an exposition of this principle. God seems to be asleep and the enemy rises. He blasphemes the name of God. Think of it in the case of Assyria. They set themselves against the God of Israel, and God allowed it all to happen. They inflated themselves almost to the heavens and said, 'Nothing can stop us.' Then God suddenly pricked the bubble and the whole empire collapsed, and the final discomfiture was very great. It is when the great big bully has made his final boast that he is brought down. If God had brought him down at the beginning it would not have seemed so wonderful. So God allows evil and evil powers to do astounding things to the world, so much so that even the godly begin to ask, Can God ever stop this? Then, when the end has almost come, God arises and down they go. The discomfiture of the enemy is greater then and more complete.

Then, again, God allows it in order to display His own greatness and glory in the defeat of such a great and mighty enemy. God arises and He demolishes him, and all who see it fear

他们一如既往自取灭亡的放纵，为的是使他们得完全和实在的破败。圣经的历史真是这原则的说明。神似乎在睡觉而敌人兴起。他亵渎神的名。想想亚述这例子。他们叫自己与以色列的神为敌，神也容许这一切发生。他们抬举自己几乎及天来说：「没有东西能阻止我们的。」之后神突然戳破这泡沫，整个帝国瓦解，那最终的挫败是十分严重的。就在那高大的暴徒作他最后的自夸时被打倒的。神若开初便打倒他的话，便不会看来如此精彩了。因此神容许邪恶和恶势力来向世人作震惊的事情时，那样严重甚至信神的人开始问：神曾否能停止这个？之后，当结局快要来到时，神醒来，他们便下去。敌人的受挫败那时便更大和更完全了。

再者，神容许这个为要在击败这样大能力的敌人时展示祂的伟大和荣耀。神起来毁坏他，所有得见的人惧怕这大能

this almighty, glorious God. All this is well illustrated at the end of Acts 12. A king called Herod seated upon a throne made a great oration to certain people, and after he had delivered his oration the people cried out saying, 'It is the voice of a god, and not of a man.' Then God, we are told, sent an angel and smote this man 'because he gave not God the glory'. 'And he was eaten of worms, and gave up the ghost. But the word of God grew and multiplied.' You see the contrast. The pomp and the greatness were demolished; but the word of the God whom the foolish king was trying to destroy grew and multiplied, and so God's glory was manifested.

The last explanation I would put forward is this: There is no doubt at all but that God sometimes permits the ungodly to flourish for the sake of disciplining His own people. I am sorry to have to say that, but I must. We need to be disciplined. How often did God raise up enemies against the Children of Israel in order to discipline them. They, His own people, had become slack and were forgetting God. He pleaded with them, He sent them prophets but they paid no attention. So He raised up Assyria, He

大力和荣耀的神。这一切在徒12章的结尾处有充足的说明。希律王坐在宝座上向某些人民进行伟大的演说，之后人民高声喊叫说：「这是神的声音，不是人的声音。」(徒12:22) 我们得知那时神差派一个天使来罚他，因为他「不归荣耀给神」。「他被虫所咬，气就绝了。神的道日见兴旺，越发广传。」(徒12:23-24) 你看见那对比，那华丽和伟大的被拆毁，愚蠢的王想摧毁的神的话却越发茁壮和增长，因此神的荣耀被显大。

在这事上我想作的最后解释是：一点也不用怀疑的是**神有时容许不信神的人昌盛，是为着管教祂一己子民**。我为着这样说而难过，但这是必须的。我们是需要管教的。神多时兴起不利于以色列民的敌人，为的是要管教他们。祂一己的子民变得松懈和忘记神。祂向他们说情，祂差派先知但他们没有留意。因此祂兴起亚述。祂兴起迦勒底人

raised up the Chaldeans to chastise, to correct His own people. And I do not hesitate to assert that many of the things we have had to endure in this century have been, partly, at least, because we, God's people, have needed to be disciplined. It was, alas, the Church herself that was largely responsible for undermining the faith of the people in the Word of God, and it is not surprising that things are now as they are. Maybe we shall have to endure much more in order that we ourselves may be humbled and brought low and brought to realize that we are God's people and that we must obey Him and rely upon Him and Him alone.

Then he ends with what happens when God does awake. 'How are they brought into desolation, as in a moment! they are utterly consumed with terrors. As a dream when one awaketh; so, O Lord, when thou awakes, thou shalt despise their image.' What is he saying: The first thing is that God does awake. 'When thou awakes.' It is going to happen. God is not permanently asleep. When it does come ... There is a limit to what God allows the ungodly. He certainly allows them to do a lot, but

来惩戒，来更正祂一己的子民。我毫不犹豫来断言说，在这个世纪我们所承受的众多东西最少部分是因着我们这些神的子民有着被管教的需要。可叹教会自己在神子民于神话语上信心的削弱上需要大大负责，事情如今来到这地步是一点也不叫人惊奇的。也许我们要忍受更多，为叫我们自己得以谦卑和降卑，并被引至明白我们是神的子民，和我们必须遵从祂，倚靠祂，单单倚靠祂。

他以神醒来时所发生的事来作结束。「他们转眼之间，成了何等的荒凉。他们被惊恐灭尽了。人睡醒了怎样看梦，主阿，祢醒了，也必照样轻看他们的影像。」（诗73:19-20）他首项要说的是神醒来，「祢醒了」必然发生。神不长久睡着。当神睡着时，神容许不信神之人的事上是有限度的。祂确实容许他们作很多事情，但祂给与敌人的

there is an end to the latitude and the apparent licence that He gives to His enemies. 'My spirit shall not always strive with man.' How long is that to go on? A key to the answer, given by God early in history, is that the godly must wait, 'for the iniquity of the Amorites is not yet full'. There is a limit. God does awake. God will awake.

'As a dream when one awaketh; so, O Lord, when thou awakes, thou shalt despise their image.' What a picture! That ungodly man, who seemed so great and marvelous, vanishes like a dream when God arises. It is as if he had been but a phantom, an image, an appearance, and had never been a reality. The ungodly who seemed so powerful, so self-sufficient and almost indestructible, when God arises are gone like a flash. The Bible is full of this. Read Isaiah 40 and you will see there that God says that to Him the nations are but 'a drop of a bucket' and as 'the small dust of the balance'. These great nations with their atomic bombs and their hydrogen bombs, these mighty nations! They are but a drop in a bucket, or the small dust of the balance. And not only that. Listen to the sarcasm and the derision. All the nations of the earth 'are as

活动范围和似乎许可上是有限度的。「我的灵不永远与人相争。」(创6:3) 到多久? 神在历史之初便给了答案, 信神的人定须等待, 「因为亚摩利人的罪孽还没有满盈。」(创15:16) 有限期。神真是醒来, 神必醒来。

「人睡醒了怎样看梦, 主阿, 祢醒了, 也必照样轻看他们的影像。」这是何等的图画! 当神醒来时, 似乎那样伟大和了不起不信神的人便如梦被消灭。他不过如同一个幻像、影像、征兆, 从未是实体。不敬虔的人似乎那权强大, 自足和不可摧毁, 但当神醒来时便如闪电而去。圣经中满是这个。读读赛40章, 你必会在那里得见神说「万民都像水桶的一滴, 又算如天平上的微尘。」(赛40:15) 这些强国拥有他们的核弹, 他们的氢弹! 但他们不过是水桶的一滴, 又算如天平上的微尘。不单如此, 听听那些讥刺和笑谈。「地上的居民好像蝗虫。」(赛40:22) 甚至

grasshoppers', even Great Britain, the U.S.A. and the U.S.S.R.! There have been other great empires and nations and commonwealths before; but they have all gone because they were not submissive to God. All the nations of the earth are but as grasshoppers—when God awakes.

You have read of Alexander the Great, so-called, one of the most skilful generals of all time, a great monarch and a mighty warrior. He conquered almost the entire known world. But Alexander the Great does come into the Scriptures, and you will find the way in which God refers to him in Daniel 8. As Walter Luthi has pointed out, he who to the world is Alexander the Great, is to God 'a he-goat'!

When God arises—Alexander the Great becomes a he-goat! When God arises that is what happens to nations, to empires, to individuals, to all. 'When thou awakest': and He has awoken. Read the history recorded in the Bible and you will find that God does arise, and when that happens His enemies are scattered and brought to nothing.

The final message, however, that comes to us out of all this is that these

英国、美国、苏联！过往曾有其它伟大的帝国、国家和联邦。但他们都过去了，因为他们不顺从神。当神醒来时世上的列国不过好像蝗虫。

你曾读过亚历山大大帝，那所谓历世历代其中一个最熟练的战略家、伟大帝王和大能战士。他几乎征服整个已知的世界。亚历山大大帝并没有在圣经中出现，在但8章中你可发现神怎说到他。正如窝打·路非所指出，于世人的亚历山大大帝，于神却是「一只公山羊」！

当神醒来时，亚历山大大帝变成一只公山羊！当神醒来时，这是在列国、帝国、个人，并一切人身上发生的事情。「当祢醒来。」祂已醒来。读读圣经的历史，神真的醒来了。当这发生时，祂的敌人被分散和进入无有。

但出于这一切并来到我们处那最终的信息

great events of history which have already happened are but a pale adumbration, and at the same time a mighty warning, of that which is to happen. The world is godless; it is Christless; it ridicules the grace of God and the Saviour of the world and especially the holy blood of His cross. The world is arrogant and vaunts its sin. But the apostle Paul, who had been greatly persecuted, writing his second letter to the Thessalonians tells us what is going to happen: 'So that we ourselves glory in you in the churches of God for your patience and faith in all your persecutions and tribulations that ye endure: which is a manifest token of the righteous judgment of God, that ye may be counted worthy of the kingdom of God, for which ye also suffer: seeing it is a righteous thing with God to recompense tribulation to them that trouble you; and to you who are troubled rest with us, when the Lord Jesus shall be revealed from heaven with his mighty angels, in flaming fire taking vengeance on them that know not God, and that obey not the gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ: who shall be punished with everlasting destruction from the presence of the Lord, and

这些历史中的重大事件，就是早已发生却是轮廓苍白，也同时是将要发生之事的大力警告。世人无神，无基督。这与神的恩典和世人的救主，尤其与祂十字架的神圣流血背道而驰。世人在其罪上自大和自夸。但那曾被大大逼害的使徒保罗在他写给帖撒罗尼迦人的第二封信中告诉我们将要发生的事：「甚至我们在神的各教会里为你们夸口，都因你们在所受的一切逼迫患难中，仍旧存忍耐和信心。」（帖后1:4）这正是神公义判断的明证。「叫你们可算配得神的国，你们就是为这国受苦。」神既是公义的，就必将患难报应那加患难给你们的人。也必使你们这受患难的人，与我们同得平安。那时，主耶稣同祂有能力的天使从天上在火焰中显现，要报应那不认识神，和那不听从我主耶稣福音的人。他们要受刑罚，就是永远沉沦，离开主的面和祂权能的荣光。这正是主降临要在

from the glory of his power; when he shall come to be glorified in his saints, and to be admired in all them that believe ... in that day.'

This is a certain as the fact that we are alive at this moment. The Lord will come riding upon the clouds of heaven and all His enemies will be scattered and routed. Satan and hell and all opposed to God will be cast into the lake of fire and go to 'everlasting destruction from the presence of the Lord'. That is the end of the ungodly. That is the power and the glory of the God whom we love and whom we adore and serve. If you do not understand what is happening, put it into that context. God is God. God is holy and just. What He has promised He will certainly perform. He permits these things for His own ends. A day is coming when He will arise and scatter His enemies, and the kingdom of Jesus Christ will stretch 'from shore to shore' and 'at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, of things in heaven, and things in earth, and things under the earth; And that every tongue should confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father'.

祂圣徒的身上得荣耀，又在一切信的人身上显为希奇的那日子。」(帖后 1:4-10)

这是与我们这刻活着这事实同样确定。主必会驾着天上的云降临，祂一切的仇敌必会被分散和击溃。撒但和地狱并所有敌对神的必会被扔进火湖和进入「永远沉沦，离开主的面」。这是不信之人的结局。这是我们所爱，所崇敬和服事之神的权柄和荣耀。你若不明白正在发生甚么事时，便将事情放进上下文中来看清楚。神就是神，神是神圣和公义的。祂所曾应许的，祂必会成就，祂是为着祂一己的目标来容许这些事情的。终有一日祂必会醒来，驱散祂的仇敌，耶稣基督的国必延展「自此岸至彼岸」，并且「万膝必向耶稣之名下拜，就是在天上、地上并地底下的；还有万口也承认耶稣基督是主，将荣耀归给父神。」

Chapter 6 Self-Examination

Thus my heart was grieved, and I was pricked in my reins. So foolish was I, and ignorant:

I was as a beast before thee.

Now this is a most important matter, and a most important point in the whole movement of the teaching of this Psalm. Let us be quite frank and honest and admit that we are very prone to stop short of this point. We are all quite happy to read about the ungodly—and I do not know anybody who has been upset about a sermon which shows how the ungodly have been set in slippery places. Then there is that great and exalted doctrine about God—'the Lord reigneth'. We all like to hear about that. We accept the teaching about the judgment of the ungodly, and we like to read about the glory and the majesty of God, because that makes us feel that everything is going to be right for us. The danger for us is to stop at that point and to go no farther. This man, however, goes on, and as he does so he not only reveals his honesty and his sincerity, and the truthfulness that was so essentially a part of his make-up, but also—and this is the thing I want to emphasize—he

六 自我反省

「因此我心里发酸，肺腑被刺。我这样愚昧无知，在祢面前如畜类一般。」（诗73:21-22）

如今来到最重要的事情，也是这诗篇整个教训流程上最重要的一点。让我们完全诚挚和忠实地承认我们是十分容易险些这样。我们全都十分乐意来读到不信神之人的情况，我不认识任何人会在显出不信神之人如何立在滑地的讲道上心烦意乱。之后有一关于神的伟大和崇高的教义——「耶和华作王」。我们全都喜爱听到这个。我们接受不信之人受审的教训，我们也喜爱读到神的荣耀和尊贵，因这使我们感到万事将会因我们而安好。我们的危险停在那儿，不思进取。但是这人继续前行，当他这样作时，不单止揭示他的诚实和他的忠诚，揭示构成他那十分重要之部分的可信，更且揭示我想强调的这样——他展示他对属灵生命性质的了解。

displays an understanding of the nature of the spiritual life.

Another wonderful example of the same thing comes in the book of Job. You remember how Job throughout the main part of that book is justifying himself, defending himself and sometimes feeling sorry for himself. But when he came truly into the presence of God, when he was in the place where he met with God, this is what he said, 'Wherefore I abhor myself, and repent in dust and ashes' (Job 42:6). There was no more godly man than Job, the most upright, the most religious man in the world. But now, because of his adversity, he no longer remembers the good things that had happened to him nor all the blessings he had enjoyed. Job had been tempted to think of God in the same way as this man in Psalm 73, and he had said things he should not have said. But when he sees God he puts his hand on his mouth and says, 'I abhor myself, and repent in dust and ashes.' I wonder whether we know that experience. Do we know what it is to abhor ourselves? Do we know what it is to repent in dust and ashes? The popular doctrine of our times does not seem to like that, because it teaches

另一个相同事情的奇妙例子在乔布记出现。你还记得乔布如何在遍及这书卷的主要部分来自我辩护，维护自己，有时为自己而难过。当他诚然来到神面前，当他站在面对神的那处时，他所说的就是：「因此我厌恶自己，在尘土和炉灰中懊悔。」（伯42:6）从来没有人像乔布般属神，完全正直，世上最敬虔的人。但如今因着他的逆境，他不再记取所发生在他身上的好事，也不记取所有他得享的恩福。乔布曾被试诱来以诗73篇这人的相同方法来想到神，他也说到他不该说的话。但当他得见神时，他便以手捂口，说：「我厌恶自己，在尘土和炉灰中懊悔。」我不知我们明白否这经历。我们知否甚么是厌恶我们自己？我们知否甚么是在尘土和炉灰中懊悔自己？我们今时的流行教义似乎不爱这样，因它教导说我们已从罗7章

that we have passed out of Romans 7. We must not talk about sorrow for sin because that would mean that we are still in the very early stages of the Christian life. So we pass over Romans 7 and turn to Romans 8. But have we ever been in Romans 7? Have we ever really said from the heart, 'O wretched man that I am! who shall deliver me from the body of this death?' Have we ever really abhorred ourselves and repented in dust and ashes? This is a very vital part of the discipline of the Christian life. Read the lives of the saints throughout the centuries and you will find that they did it very frequently. Go back to Henry Martyn, for example; go back to any of those mighty men of God, and you will find that they frequently abhorred themselves. They hated their lives in this world; they hated themselves in that sense. And it was because of this that they were so mightily blessed of God.

Nothing is more important, therefore, than for us to follow the Psalmist and so exactly what he did. We must learn to turn upon ourselves and to deal with ourselves faithfully. It is a vital matter in the Christian life. What are the steps? I have tried to

出来。我们一定不可再谈到为罪忧伤，因为这意味着我们仍在基督徒生命的初阶。因此我们经过罗7章，来到罗8章。但我们曾否来过罗7章？我们曾否真的从心底说「我真是苦阿，谁能救我脱离这取死的身體呢？」（罗7:24）？我们曾否真的厌恶自己，并在尘土和炉灰中懊悔自己？这是基督徒生命管教中十分重要的部分。读读世纪以来圣徒的生命，必会发现他们极经常作这个。回头看看亨利·马田，回头看看那些神大能之人的任何人，你必会发现他们经常厌恶他们自己。他们恨恶他们在今世的生命，他们是这样恨恶自己的。他们是因此而蒙受神大大之赐福的。

没有东西比起我们跟随诗人并完全照他所作的来作更重要。我们必须学会转向自己和诚实处理自己。这是基督徒生命中重要的事情。有甚么步骤？我曾尝试用以下

divide them in the following way. First and foremost we must really confess what we have done. Now we do not like doing that. We are aware of what we have done, and our tendency is to say, 'I turn to Christ, and at once I am forgiven and all is well.' That is an error. We must confess what we have done. This man had spent a lot of time in commiserating with himself, in looking at other people and envying them. He had spent a lot of time with unworthy thoughts about God and His ways. But after his recovery in the sanctuary he says to himself, 'I must spend an equal amount of time in looking at myself and looking at what I have done.' We must not spare ourselves. We must really confess what we have done, which means that we must deliberately hold these things before ourselves. We must not shield ourselves in any way; we must not attempt to slide over our sin; we must not merely take a casual glance at it. We must hold the facts before ourselves deliberately and say, 'This is what I did; this is what I thought and what I said.'

That is why he ends by saying, 'I was as a beast.' He confessed, 'I actually thought that about Thee, O

的方式来分别他们：我们必须首先承认我们曾作的。现在不喜欢这样作。我们觉知我们曾作的，便倾向说：「我转向基督，立时得着饶恕，万事安好了。」这是错误的。我们定须承认我们所作之事。这人花了很多时间望向别人和嫉妒他们下来同情自己。他曾花了大量时间在神和祂的行径上有无谓的思想。但在圣所的发现之后，他对自己说：「我定须花相同的时间来看自己，看我曾作之事。」我们必不可宽恕自己。我们须真的承认我们所作的，这是说我们必须刻意将这些事情放在我们面前。我们一定不可以任何方式来庇护自己，我们一定不可试图回避我们的罪，我们一定不可对罪投以淡然的一顾。我们必须将事实刻意摆在眼前，且说「这是我所作，所想和我所说。」

为这他终说「我如畜类一般。」他承认「我实在想到神祢，我几乎要说

God, and I was on the point of saying it—that is what I really did.’ He put it before himself and he held it there until he was crushed to the ground and felt he was ‘as a beast’. We shall never really abhor ourselves unless we do that. We have to hold our sin before us until we really see it for what it is.

This poor man in Psalm 73 was being controlled by his heart, but he did not know it. He thought he was reasoning our facts. The heart is ‘deceitful’; it is so clever and subtle. That is why we must watch it. ‘This is the condemnation,’ we read in John 3:19, ‘that light is come into the world, and men loved darkness rather than light, because their deeds were evil.’ It is the heart that is wrong, so we end with the advice of the wise man in Proverbs 4:23, ‘Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life.’ Watch your heart, watch yourself, watch your feelings. When your heart is sour everything will be sour and nothing will be right. It is the heart that governs everything and there is only one final treatment for this sour and bitter heart. It is to come to God as the Psalmist came, and to realize that God in His infinite love and grace,

这个，这真是我所作。」他将这摆在面前不放，直至摔倒地上，感到他就「如畜类一般」。我们永不会真的厌恶自己，除非我们这样作。我们必须将我们的罪摆在我们前面，直至我们真的得见它的所是。

诗73篇中瞠然不知的可怜人正被他心管理。他以为他实在讲道理。欺哄人的心那样聪明狡猾。为此我们须监察它。在约3:19中我们读到「光来到世间，世人因自己的行为是恶的。」出错的是心，因此我们是以那老者的「你要切切保守你心，因为一生的果效，是由心发出。」（箴4:23）劝告为依归。保守你心、你自己、你的情感。当你的心发酸时，事事也发酸，没有事情会对。是心管理万事，对这发酸发苦的心只有一个最终处理，就是如同诗人般来到神处，来明白神因无限的爱和恩典，差祂儿子进入世界来死在十字架上，叫我们厌恶自己，得着宽恕和一再得着

in His mercy and compassion sent His Son into the world to die upon the cross that we should come to abhor ourselves, that we might be forgiven and once more have a clean heart, that David's prayer might be answered, 'Create in me a clean heart, O God.'

Chapter VII Spiritual Allergy

Thus my heart was grieved, and I was pricked in my reins. So foolish was I, and ignorant:

I was as a beast before thee.

He tells us in these two verses. The first thing he discovered when he really saw the position truly was that he had very largely been producing his own troubles and his own unhappiness. He found in the sanctuary of God that his trouble was not really the ungodly at all; it was himself. He found that he had, to use our phrase, 'worked himself up' into this condition. Now let me give you the evidence for that. Verse 21 in the Authorized Version reads, 'Thus my heart was grieved, and I was pricked in my reins.' This translation rather suggest that something had happened to his heart; something had happened to his 'reins', his kidneys, another seat of the feelings and emotions according

新心，叫大卫「神阿，求祢为我造清洁的心。」(诗 51:10) 的祷告得蒙垂听。

七 属灵的反感

「因而我心里发酸，肺腑被刺。我这样愚昧无知，在祢面前如畜类一般。」(诗 73:21-22)

在这两节经文中他告诉我们，当他真的看见他真实的地位，他首先发现到是他一直做成他一己的问题和他一己不快的。在神的圣所中他发现到他的问题真的一点也是出于不信之人的，而是出于他自己。他发现到(用上我们的字句)是他「叫他自己作成」这状况的。如今让我给你这个的证据。钦定本的21节是这样译法的：「因而我心里发酸，肺腑被刺。」这译法有点儿说到有事情发生在他心上，有事情发生在他肺腑上。根据古时的心理学，他的肺腑是感觉

to ancient psychology. But what this man actually said was something slightly different. These words which are in the verse 21 are reflexive. What he is saying is that he had done something to himself. He is saying, 'I have sourced my heart.' And as regards the reins you can translate like this, 'I was preparing for myself a piercing pain.' He had been doing it himself. He had been stimulating his own heart, he had been exacerbating his own trouble, he had been souring his own feelings. He himself had really been producing his own troubles and giving rise to this piercing pain which he had been enduring until he went into the sanctuary of God.

This man discovered all that in the sanctuary of God. He had been grieving himself; he had produced his own misery and he had kept it up. He had exaggerated the whole thing instead of facing it honestly. He was not in all this great trouble; he was not really having a hard time. He was just looking at things in such a way as to give himself a hard time—foolish man that he was! Are we not all like him at times—foolish creatures that we are?

Now the opposite to all this is that blessed condition which is

和情感的另一个座位。但这人所真实说到的东西是稍为不同的。21节所用是反射字眼。他说他一直为己来作事。他是说：「我曾叫我心酸痛。」在论到肺腑时，你也可这样翻译：「我为自己预备了一个锥心之痛。」他一直这样对待自己。他一直在刺激他一己的心，他一直加重他一己的问题，他一直弄酸他一己的情感。诚然是他自己造成一己的问题，带来所一直承受的锥心之痛，直至他去到神的圣所。

这人在神的圣所中发现这一切。他一直为己忧伤，制造和保存他一己痛苦。他一直夸大整件事，不诚实来面对它。他全然不是在这大困难中，并非落在艰难时刻。他不过以这方式看事物来给自己困难时刻，他何等愚蠢啊！我们不也有时全都像他么，我们都是何等愚蠢的生物啊！

与这一切相反的蒙福情况记载在腓

described in Philippians 4:11-13. Paul puts it like this, 'For I have learned, in whatsoever state I am, therewith to be content. I know both how to be abased, and I know how to abound: every where and in all things I am instructed both to be full and to be hungry, both to abound and to suffer need. I can do all things through Christ which strengthened me.' In other words, he has arrived at a condition in which he is no longer hyper-sensitive. He is in a condition in which it does not matter very much what happens to him; it is not going to disturb him. 'I have learned, in whatsoever state I am, therewith to be content.' That is the position in which all of us who are Christians should be. The man who is not a Christian is not there, and cannot possibly be there. He is like a barrel of gunpowder; you never know when there is going to be an explosion. The slightest pin-prick cause great trouble; he is hyper-sensitive because of self. But the apostle Paul had remembered what our Lord puts first to His disciples, namely, 'If any man will come after me, let him deny himself.' Self must be put out first. Then let him 'take up his cross, and follow me'. Because self is dethroned

4:11-13。保罗这样说：「我无论在甚么景况都可以知足，这是我已经学会了。我知道怎样处卑贱，也知道怎样处丰富。或饱足，或饥饿，或有余，或缺乏，随事随在，我都得了秘诀。我靠着那加给我力量的，凡事都能作。」换句话说，他已到达在其中便不再过度敏感的状况。他已到达不再十分紧张会有甚么事情发生在他身上的状况，这不会困扰他。「我无论在甚么景况都可以知足，这是我已经学会了。」这是所有基督徒该有的地位。非基督徒不在那里，也不可能在那里。他就像一桶炸药，你永不知何时会发生爆炸。最微细的触发也会酿成巨祸。他是因己而过度敏感。使徒保罗记取我们的主首要嘱咐祂门徒的，就是：「若有人要跟从我，就当舍己。」（太16:24）必须先将己除掉，之后叫他「背起他的十字架来跟从我」。因为己被废黜和抛在背后，门徒不再过度敏感，这些事情也

and put into the background, the disciple is not hyper-sensitive, and these things do not cause troubles and alarms and explosions. He is balanced because self is put out and he is living for Christ.

The next thing this man discovered was that he had become stupid. The Authorized Version translates verse 22 as, 'So foolish was I.' But that word really means 'stupid' and a much better word it is. He was like a beast, utterly irrational, behaving in a stupid, absurd manner. But this is always true of the condition that we are describing and analyzing. What does it mean exactly? 'So stupid was I, and ignorant.' 'I was'—he repeats the emphasis—'I was as a beast before thee.' Again let us note his honesty, his truthful dealings with himself. He does not spare himself at all; he has seen the truth about himself and he states it—'I was as a beast before thee.' What does it mean? First and foremost it means that he was behaving instinctively. What is the difference between a beast and a man? I have already partly suggested the answer. Surely God's supreme gift to man is understanding and reason and the power to think. The animal

不再造成麻烦、恐慌和爆炸。因着已被除掉，并为基督而活，所以他稳妥了。

这人第二样发现的就是他的愚蠢。修定本把22节译成为：「我是何等的愚蠢啊！」但这字其实是意思「懒惰」这好得多的词语。他像一头野兽，完全不理性的，以懒惰和荒谬来行事。但在说到我们所描述和分析的状况时便总是对的。这其实作何解？「我是何等愚蠢，何等无知！」他重复这强调：「是我，我在祢面前如畜类一般。」让我们再次留心他的忠心，他诚实地对待自己。他完全不放过自己，他看见一己的真相，便说：「我在祢面前如畜类一般。」这作何解？这首要地说到他按本能来行事。畜类和人类有何分别？我已给与部分的答案。无疑神给人的无上恩赐就是领悟力、理解力和思想的能力。动物也许高度智慧，但牠缺乏

may be highly intelligent; but it lacks that true quality and faculty of reasons, however much it may sometimes appear to the contrary. It lacks the power to stand outside itself, to consider itself and its actions. It is man alone who can do that, and that is a part of the image of God in man. But take the question of the migration of birds. A study of these matters makes it obvious that instinct rather than intelligence governs that marvelous phenomenon. In other words, animal behaviour is a matter of instinctive response to a given stimulus. Well, this man tells us that he had been behaving like that. In other words, he did not stop to think; he did not stop to ponder and reason about his problem. To be stupid means not to think logically, not to think clearly. You and I are meant to think logically, we are meant to think rationally, we are meant to think consecutively. But this man had not been thinking like that, he had been like the animal. The animal responds to the stimulus immediately and mechanically, without any interval for thought.

One of the great differences between a Christian and a non-Christian should be that the

理性的真正素质和机能，而牠也许有时却会有着相反的表现。牠缺乏能力来叫自己置身于外下来想到自己和其行为。独有人能这样作，这是神在人里头形像的一部分。就以雀鸟的迁徙这问题为例，在这些事情上的研究叫人明显知道是本能而不是智慧管理着这奇妙的现象。换句话说，动物的行为是对刺激的本能反应。那么这人告诉我们说他一直有这样的表现。换句话说，他没有停下来思想，他没有停下来沉思和理解他的问题。行事愚蠢是说到不以逻辑来思考，没有清晰的思想。你和我天生是要逻辑思考，要连贯地思想。但这人一直没有这样，他一直像畜类。动物对刺激作出立时和机械化的反应，没有思想的间隔。诗人一直这样。

一个基督徒和一个非基督徒最大的分别应该是基督徒总会叫刺激

Christian always puts in an interval between the stimulus and the response. The Christian should always put everything into another context. He should think about it; he should not jump to conclusions; he should work the thing out. The Christian is a man who thinks in a different manner from the non-Christian. His thinking is logical, clear, calm, controlled and balanced; and above everything else it is spiritual. He thinks everything out in terms of this great truth that he has here in the New Testament. But the animal cannot do that. 'I was as a beast before thee; I was stupid.' That kind of behavior is not only like an animal's, it is more or less like a child's also. A child behaves like that because its reasoning faculty has not sufficiently advanced and developed. It jumps to conclusions; it reacts to stimuli like the animal. It has to be trained to think and to reason, and not so be stupid.

Another way in which the Psalmist found that he had been stupid was this. He had obviously held an idea of the godly life which was quite false. He desired pleasure the whole time and thought that his life was to be one long round of sunshine and happiness. That was what had

和反应之间有间隔。基督徒该总会设身处地来看每件事情。他该想想这个，他不应该很快便跳至结论去，他该弄清事情的真相。基督徒是一个以不同于非基督徒的态度来思想的人。他的思想是逻辑的、清晰的、平静的、受控的和平衡的，最重要的是它是属灵的。他是按在新约这里的伟大真理来思想事情的。但动物不能这样。「在祢面前我就如同一只畜类，我是愚蠢的。」这样的行为不单止像一只畜类，或多或少就像一个孩童。一个孩童有像这的表现是因为其推理机能不足以改进和发展下便跳往结论，像动物般向刺激作出反应。孩童需要训练思想和推理才不那样愚蠢。

诗人循另一途径发现他一直都很愚蠢。明显地他一直持守的敬虔生活观念是完全错误的。他渴望全时间快乐，认为他的生命是长长阳光普照和快乐的循环。就是这个使他抱怨说：「我实在徒然

made him complain and say, 'I have cleansed my heart in vain, and washed my hands in innocence. For all the day long have I been plagued, and chastened every morning.' We tend to take all the gifts and the pleasures and the happiness and the joy without saying much to God about it. But the moment anything goes wrong we begin to grumble. We take our health and strength, our food and clothing and our loved ones, all for granted. But the moment anything goes wrong we start grumbling and complaining and we say, 'Why should God do this to me? Why should this happen to me?' How slow we are to thank, how swift to grumble. But that is like the animal, is it not? The animal likes to be petted and patted. He eats and enjoys his food. But the moment you correct him he does not like it. that is typical of the animal, and it is typical of the child outlook. The child will take all you give it. But if you withhold something it wants, it resents it. That is being stupid. That is the failure to think. That is the childish, stupid, beast-like attitude. But how true it is; it was true of this man and it is true of us.

Now this is characteristic of the immature Christian, the babe in Christ.

洁净了我的心，徒然洗手表明无辜。因为我终日遭灾难，每早晨受惩治。」（诗73:13-14）我们倾向于接受所有恩赐、乐趣、快意、欢乐，却不为此而向神多说。当事情不顺利时却立时抱怨。我们取用我们的健康、力量、食物、衣着和我们所爱的人，以为理所当然。当有任何事不妥时，我们便开始抱怨，投诉说：「为何神对我这样？为何这发生在我身上？」我们在感恩上何等缓慢，埋怨上何等快速。这就像畜类，不是吗？动物喜爱被爱抚和轻拍。牠吃和享受牠的食物。一旦被校正，便会不高兴。动物就是这样，孩子气就是这样。孩子接受你给的一切，你若不给他所想望的东西时，他便不满。这是愚蠢，不去思想。这态度是孩子气、愚蠢、像畜类。却又何等真确，于这人于我们也真确。

这是不成熟基督徒的特征，在基督里为婴

Such a person resents discipline, and yet the answer to that is plain and unequivocal. The author of the Epistle to the Hebrews does not hesitate to use a striking and almost surprising phrase. He says, 'If you are not experiencing chastisement there is only one explanation for it and that is you are not children of God, you are bastards; (see Hebrews 12:8). If you are a child of God then you are certainly going to be disciplined, because God is preparing you for holiness. He is not an indulgent father who hands out sweets indiscriminately and does not care what happens to us. God is holy, and He is preparing us for Himself and for glory; and because we are what we are, and because sin is in us, and because the world is what it is, we must needs be disciplined. So He sends us trials and tribulations in order to pull us up, and to conform us to 'the image of his Son'. But we do not like it, and like the animal we squeal because we dislike pain. But if we thought, if we were not stupid, we would even thank God for the pain. We would say with the writer of Psalm 119, 'It is good for me that I have been afflicted.' I sometimes think that there is no better test of the Christian position

孩。这样的人憎恶管教，然而这事的答案是清楚和毫不含糊的。希伯来书的作者毫不犹豫用上一异乎寻常甚至令人惊讶的句子，他说：「管教原是众子所共受的，你们若不受管教，就是私子，不是儿子了。」（来12:8）你若是神的儿女，那么肯定要被管教，因为神装备你来圣洁。祂不是任意给糖果，不关心有甚么事发生在我们身上的纵容父母。神是圣洁的，祂也正为祂自己和荣耀来装备我们；因着我们的所是、在我们里头的罪、世界的所是，所以我们必须被管教。因此祂给我们试炼和灾难，为要把我们提升，模造我们成为「祂儿子的模样」。我们不喜欢这个，却像动物般喜爱抱怨，皆因我们不爱受苦。我们若思想，我们若不再愚蠢，我们甚至为痛苦来感谢神时，我们会与诗119篇的作者一同说：「我受苦是与我有益，为要使我学习祢的律例。」（诗119:71）有时我想没有比

than just that, that we can even thank God for trials and troubles and for chastisement, because we see that they have been used of God to bring us nearer and closer to Himself.

The next thing this man found about himself is that he was ignorant. To be ignorant is not the same thing as to be stupid, but stupidity usually leads to ignorance. This man was ignorant about the true position of the ungodly; he was ignorant about God; he was ignorant about himself, and about the very nature of the life he was living. He had forgotten about the whole purpose of godly living. And if you and I react as this man reacted to trials and troubles, in the last analysis there is only one thing to say about us, and that is that we are ignorant.

What are we ignorant of? We are ignorant of everything the Bible says about the godly life, and we are especially ignorant about the New Testament Epistles, all of which have been written to enlighten this particular ignorance. So if we always grumble about God's dealings with us and complain of His chastisements, we are simply making the confession either that we do not know our Scriptures at all, and that we have

这更好试验基督徒，我们甚至可为着试炼、困苦和斥责来感谢神，得见神用他们叫我们得接近祂和与祂更亲近。

这人在关乎到他自己身上所发现的第二件事就是他的无知。无知与愚蠢是不相同的，但愚蠢通常会导至无知。这人在不信神之人的真正地位上无知。他对自己无知，对他正活着之生命的性质上无知。他已忘记属神之人生命的原有目的。你和我若像这人对试炼和困苦的反应来反应的话，归根究底只有一事可说到我们，就是我们是无知的。

我们在甚么事上无知？我们在圣经说到属神生命的各样事上无知，我们尤其在特特写来光照无知的新约书信上无知。因此我们若常埋怨神如何对待我们，抱怨祂的严厉批评时，我们一是承认我们完全不认识我们的圣经，我们也从不明白新约，一是我们是故意的无知，为着我们拒绝来思

never understood the New Testament, or else that we are willfully ignorant, that we refuse to think and to apply what we know. We see these books, but we refuse to listen to the arguments and we refuse to allow them to apply themselves to us. 'Ignorant.' This man says, 'I was behaving as an ignoramus; I was behaving as if I knew nothing about Thy purposes; I was behaving as if I were a mere tyro in these matters, as if I had never read or heard the history of the past.' And it is perfectly true of us also. The moment we allow our heart and our feelings to get into control we become hyper-sensitive or allergic in this sense; and we behave just as if we knew nothing but were ignorant and as a beast in the presence of God.

That brings us to the final matter, which is the worst of all. Listen, 'Thus I exacerbated my own heart and I pricked myself in my reins and gave myself pain. So stupid was I and so ignorant, like an ignoramus; indeed I was as a beast *before thee*.' I think that that was the thing that broke this man's heart, and it is the thing that ought to break all our hearts. You see, in the sanctuary of

想和运用我们所认识的。我们看见这些书卷，但我们拒绝来聆听所论到的，我们拒绝来容许他们应用在我们身上。「无知」。这人说：「我像一个无知的人来行事，我如同在祢旨意上一无所知的人般来行事。在这些事上我就算不过如同一个初学者来行事，如同我从未读过或听过过去的历史一般。」我们也正是这样。我们容许我们的心和情感被控制那刻起，我们便变得过度敏感，或过敏。我们的行径就如同我们一无所知，在神面前如同畜类一般无知。

这带我们来到最糟糕的最后一件事。听听：「因而我心里发酸，肺腑被刺。我这样愚昧无知，在祢面前如畜类一般。」（诗73:25）我想是这个伤破了这人的心，这个也会伤破我们所有人的心。你得见这人在圣所中明白到他一直想的在神面前实在是这些可怖、无价

God this man realized that he had been thinking all these horrible, unworthy, foolish, stupid things actually in the presence of God. 'Before thee.' That is why he thought of himself as a beast. Fancy thinking these things, and being on the point of saying them, in the presence of God! What he had forgotten was that God is 'a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart', and 'Neither is there any creature that is not manifest in his sight: but all things are naked and opened unto the eyes of him with whom we have to do' (Hebrews 4:12, 13). If only we realized that, we should never again behave as this man did and as we, to our shame, have often done.

Chapter VIII 'Nevertheless'

Nevertheless I am continually with thee: thou hast holden me by my right hand. Thou shalt guide me with thy counsel, and afterward receive me to glory.

The Psalmist has humiliated himself to the very dust, he has put on his sackcloth and ashes. He admits that there is nothing to be said for a man who sulks and behaves as he had done in the presence of God—'before thee'.

值、鲁莽、愚蠢的事。「在祢面前」。就是这原因他想到自己如同一只畜类。幻想一下想到这些东西，快要说出这些东西的一刹那，是在神的面前！他所忘记的是神「连心中的思念和主意，都能辨明。.....并且被造的，没有一样在祂面前不显然的。原来万物在那与我们有关系的主眼前都是赤露敞开的。」(来4:12-13) 只要我们明白这个，我们便永不会再有如同那人和我们从前所常作叫我们羞耻的这样表现。

八 然而

「然而我常与祢同在。祢搀着我的右手。祢要以祢的训言引导我，以后必接我到荣耀里。」(诗73:23-24)

诗人谦卑自己至极，他披麻蒙灰。他承认在神面前绷脸和有他曾有之举动上无话可说，「在祢面前」。但感谢神的是他没有停在那儿。他以这伟

But thank God he does not stop at that. He goes on with this great and blessed word 'nevertheless'.

First of all, we look at God's restraining grace. 'Thou hast holden me by my right hand.' This is as if he were saying, 'When I was going down You were there. You pulled me back; You saved me.' The Fathers used to make a great deal of this restraining grace of God. This was his position—'As for me, my feet were almost gone; my steps had well-nigh slipped.' Why did he not slip? He now begins to understand. He had not seen it until this point. What saved him was that God held him back by his right hand. It was God who steadied him at the moment just before his final fall. God took a further grip of him; and just when he was on the point of going, He held him.

Psalms 37:24 expresses the same thought. The Psalmist there is describing the righteous man and he says, 'Though he fall, he shall not be utterly cast down; for the Lord upholdeth him with his hand.' It is the same thought. It is important that this truth be put plainly. The doctrine, you observe, does not say that the Christian man never falls. Alas, he

大和蒙福的「然而」一字词来勇往直前。

首先，我们看看神束缚的恩典。「祢搀着我的右手。」这就如同说「当我退后时祢在那里。祢将我拉回。祢救了我。」父亲们常大量用上神这束缚的恩典。这是他的立场——「至于我，我的脚几乎失闪，我的脚险些滑跌。」为甚么他滑跌？如今他开始明白了。他一直看不见这个，直至来到这点。神搀着他的右手来拯救他。就在他最后堕落之前是神来使他站稳。神进一步握紧他，就在他来到要离去之时，祂把他挽回。

诗37:24表达相同的意思。诗人在那里描述义人，他说：「他虽失脚，也不至全身仆倒，因为耶和华用手搀扶他。」这是相同的意思。这真理的说得显浅是重要的。你看到这教义不是说基督徒永不会跌倒。可叹，他跌倒了。但他不至全身仆倒。

does; but he is never 'utterly cast down'. This doctrine concerns the backslider. Are we clear about it? A backslider is obviously a man who falls; but it is equally right to say that he is a man who is never utterly cast down. Some people do not understand this doctrine of the backslider. They say that if a man who appears to be Christian falls into sin then that man has never been a Christian. They are quite wrong. Surprising things can happen to a Christian, and a Christian can do surprising things. But the doctrine concerning the backslider teaches that, though he may fall, he is not utterly cast down. In other words, he always comes back; he does not remain in sin. He is a man who has what is called 'a temporary fall'. There are people who appear to be Christian, but who have never done more than give merely an intellectual assent to the truth. They have never been born again, and they ultimately renounce the truth. These are not backsliders. It is only of the true Christian that the term 'backslide' can be used.

He had come to see that God was holding his right hand, and that at the vital point He had pulled him back. But He did not stop there. What was it that

这教义是论到后退。我们在这点上清不清晰？一个倒退的人明显是一个跌倒的人，但说到他是一个永不全身仆倒也同样是对的。有人不明白这后退的教义。他们说一个似乎是基督徒的人因罪跌倒的话，这人便从来不是一个基督徒了。他们完全错了。惊人的事情会发生在基督徒身上的，基督徒也会作一些惊人的事情。但这论到后退者的教义是教导我们说，虽然他可能跌倒，他却不至全身仆倒，他总会回头，他不会依然在罪中。这是一个称为「暂时跌倒」的人。有人看来是基督徒，他们所作的不过只对真理给与智力上的认同。他们从未曾重生，他们最终是放弃真理的。他们不是后退者，惟有真实的基督徒能用上后退者这字眼。

他现在得见神正搀着他的右手。就在这关键一刻他被拉回。但他没有停在那儿。是甚么把他从

had brought him right back? He was so miserable, so envious of the foolish. What was it that brought him back and enabled him to understand? Some may feel that that is an unnecessary question, because we have seen that it was entirely the result of his going to the sanctuary of God. He tells us that himself. 'When I thought to know this, it was too painful for me; until I went into the sanctuary of God; then understood I their end.' What restored the man was his decision to go to the sanctuary of God.

But what took him there? There is only one answer to that; God's restoring grace. I suggest that he went there because God put it into his mind. As we say so glibly, it was something that 'occurred' to him. But why did it occur to him? The answer is, God put it into his mind.

Chapter IX The Final Perseverance of the Saints

Thou shalt guide me with thy counsel, and afterward receive me to glory.

Now the Psalmist gives us a remarkable statement of that doctrine. He turns to God and this is what he says, 'Thou shalt guide me with thy

那样同情和羡慕愚昧人中带回？是甚么把他带回，并使他能够明白？有人觉得这是一不必要的问题，因为我们得见这全然是他来到神圣所的结果。他亲自告诉我们「我思索怎能明白这事，眼看实系为难。等我进了神的圣所，思想他们的结局。」是他往神圣所去的决定叫他得恢复的。

甚么领他去那儿？答案是神恢复的恩典。我认为他去那里，是因神将这放进他的心思。我们说得随意，是有事情「发生」在他身上。为何这会发生在自己身上？答案就是是神将这放进他心。

九 圣徒的最终忍耐

「祢要以祢的训言引导我，以后必接我到荣耀里。」（诗73:24）

如今诗人给我们这教义的非凡句子，这是他转向神时所说的：「祢要以祢的训言引导我，以后

counsel, and afterward receive me to glory.’ Many commentators have disagreed about the exact rendering of that. Some do not like the word ‘afterward’. They say it should read, ‘Thou shalt lead me after glory.’ However, the meaning is one and the same. ‘Afterward.’ Whether we put these words in the present or the future there is a continuous element there.

The Psalmist puts it like this, ‘Thou shalt guide me with thy counsel.’ He leads; He guide. He does all the things which we were considering in our previous study. He restrains us, He works within us—‘work out your own salvation with fear and trembling. For it is God which worketh in you both to will and to do’ (Philippians 2:12f.). That is how He preserves His people; that is how He sustains us by His grace; that is how He delivers us from sin. He works in us, in our minds as well as in our dispositions and desires. Peter, at the beginning of the Second Epistle, reminds the people to whom he is writing that they have been given ‘all things that pertain unto life and godliness’. ‘All things’—everything that is necessary to live a godly life is given to us in the Scriptures, in the Holy

必接我到荣耀里。」很多解经家在正确的译文上没有共识。有人不喜欢「以后」这词语。他们说该译作「祢在我得荣耀后引导我。」无论如何，意思只得一个，也是相同的。无论我们将「以后」放在现今还是将来，总有着持续的成分。

诗人这样写：「祢要以祢的训言引导我。」祂带领，祂引导。祂作了所有我们在前前研究中所思想的一切。祂阻止我们，在我们里头作工。就当恐惧战兢，作成你们得救的工夫。因为你们立志行事，都是神在你们心里运行。」（腓2:12-13）这是神保存祂子民的方法，藉祂的恩典来维持我们，是救我们脱离罪的方法。祂在我们里头工作，在我们的心思、意向和渴望中。彼得提醒他的受信人已得赐「一切关乎生命和虔敬的事」（彼后1:3）。「一切」，在圣经、在圣灵里、和在基督的位格上给我们所有必须活出属

Spirit, in the Person of Christ. By means of these things God leads us, and sustains us, He holds and perfect us. He is dealing with us. We are His workmanship and His chisel is used upon us. You have been ill? It may have been God doing it. 'For this cause many are weak and sickly among you', says Paul in 1 Corinthians 11:30. Because some of the members of the church at Corinth had not been examining and judging themselves, God had had to deal with them through sickness of illness. 'Whom the Lord loveth he chasteneth, and scourgeth every son whom he receiveth' (Hebrews 12:6). That is often a part of His process in sustaining us and bringing us to that ultimate glorification that awaits us.

Let me end with this. What does all this process lead to? According to this man it leads to 'glory'. 'Thou shalt'—and if you prefer the other translation—'thou shalt ... lead me on after glory.' It means that if we are thus in God's hands, and are being sustained by Him, we arrive at a certain amount of glory even here in this world. Even in this world we begin to enjoy something of the fruits of salvation, of the life that is glory. The

神生命的每一样东西。神是藉着这些来引领我们和维持我们的，他托住我们，使我们完全，祂是这样待我们的。我们都是祂的工作，祂的凿子用在我们身上。你曾否生病？这也许是神作的。「因此，在你们中间有好些软弱的，与患病的。」（林前11:30）因有哥林多教会会众不检视和自审，神不得不藉软弱和患病来管教他们。「因为主所爱的祂必管教，又鞭打凡所收纳的儿子。」（来12:6）这常是维持和领我们到等待着我们那终极荣耀祂那过程的一部分。

让我们以此作结。这一切过程引往那里？如人所说这引往「荣耀」去。有别的翻译，「在我得荣耀后祂必引导我。」（诗73:24）这说到我们在神手中，正被祂维持，我们就是在今世的这里也达至某程度分量的荣耀。就算在今世我们也开始得享救恩果子和荣耀生命的一些东西。圣灵的恩

gifts of the Spirit, the graces of the Spirit, the fruit of the Spirit—that is all a part of the glory. When God begins to produce these things in you He is glorifying you. He makes you unlike the world and its people; He makes you like Christ. Something of the glory of the blessed Lord belongs to you.

But I imagine someone saying, 'Is not this rather dangerous doctrine? Is there not a danger that someone may say, "Well, as I am saved, it does not matter what I do"?' My reply is this. If you can listen to the doctrine I have been enunciating and draw that deduction, then you have no spiritual life in you—you are dead. 'Every man that hath this hope in him', says John in 1 John 3:3, 'purifieth himself, even as he is pure.' If you were promised an audience with some great person, you would prepare yourself for it. And what I have been telling you is that if you are a child of God you are going to be ushered into the eternal presence and you will stand before the glory of God. 'Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God.' The more certain I am of that, the more concerned shall I be about my sanctification and purity, and the more I shall purify myself. The time is short. I

赐、恩惠、果子，全都是荣耀的一部分。当神开始在你里头产生这些东西时，祂是正荣耀你的。祂使你不像世界和其上的人民，祂使你像基督。恩主荣耀中的一些东西属于你的了。

但我想有人会说：「这不是一有点危险的教义么？不是存在着危险，以至有人说：『那么，我既是得救了，那么我作甚么都不重要了。』？」我的回答是，你若是听到我发表的教义而作这推论的话，那么在你里头是没有属灵生命的了，你是死的。约翰在约壹3:3说：「就洁净自己，像祂洁净一样。」若约定你的是有着一些重要人物的多人听众时，你便会为此来预备自己。我所告诉你的是，你若是神的儿女，你便将被引领进入永恒的同在中，你也必会站在神的荣耀前。「清心的人有福了，因为他们必得见神。」（太5:8）我越肯定这个，便越发关注我的成圣和洁净，也越发洁净

know that the end is coming; I have not a moment to lose. I must prepare with more and more diligence for 'the crowning day' that is coming 'by and by'.

God grant that we all, as we look back at our past 'Ebenezers' (see 1 Samuel 7:12), may enjoy this glorious, blessed certainty that He cannot, He will not forsake us. We are certain—blessed be the name of God—

Chapter X The rock of Ages

*Whom have I in heave but thee?
and there is none upon earth that
I desire beside thee.*

*My flesh and my heart faileth:
but God is the strength of my
heart, and my portion for ever.*

This man had been through all that, and now has come to see that the greatest of all blessings is just to know God and to be in His presence.

There are many examples of this in the Bible. Psalm 42:1, 2 expresses it perfectly, 'As the hart panteth after the water brooks, so panteth my soul after thee, O God.' That man is crying out for this direct knowledge of God, this immediate experience of God. His

自己。时日无多了，我知道结局正来，「得冠冕之日」很快就要来到了。

当我们回望过去的「以便以谢」(撒下7:12)时，神给予我们所有人得享这荣耀，蒙福的肯定祂不能和必不撇弃我们。我们肯定，愿神名被称颂。

十 万古磐石

「除祢以外，在天上我有谁呢？除祢以外，在地上我也没有所爱慕的。我的肉体，和我的心肠衰残。但神是我心里的力量，又是我的福分，直到永远。」(诗73:25-26)

这人已经过这一切，如今得见最大的恩福就只是认识神和可到祂跟前。

在圣经中有很多这样的例子。诗42:1-2完美地表述这个。「神阿，我的心切慕你，如鹿切慕溪水。我的心渴想神。」这人呼喊着重要直接认识神，这立时的经历神。他的心

soul 'panteth', he is 'thirsting' for Him, the living God. Not God as an idea, not God as a source and fount of blessing, but the living Person Himself. The apostle Paul says exactly the same thing in Philippians 3:10, 'If you ask me,' says Paul, 'what my greatest desire is, it is this: "That I may know him."' You notice his supreme ambition. Let me not be misunderstood as I put it plainly. His supreme ambition was not to be a great soul winner. That was one ambition of his, and a right one. It was not even to be a great preacher. No, beyond it all, including it all, 'That I may know him.' Because, as the apostle reminds us elsewhere, if you put the other things first you may find yourself, even as a preacher, becoming, in a sense, a castaway.

Now let me put it another way. This man not only desires God Himself, he desires nothing but God. He is exclusive in his desire. Do you ever look forward to being in heaven? That is not being morbid. I like the way in which Matthew Henry put it: 'We are never told in the Scriptures that we should look forward to death; but we are told very frequently that we should look forward to heaven.' The

切慕神，他渴想神，永生神。不是作为意念的神，不是作为恩福之来源和涌泉的神，而是那永活者本身。使徒保罗在腓3:10说的也相同。「你若问我最大的渴望是甚么，就是『使我认识基督。』」当留心他无比的志向。我不愿误导，因此我坦白来说。他的志向并非作赢取灵魂的人。这是他其中一个对的志向；也不是要成为伟大的传道者。「使我认识基督」超越和包括这一切。正如他在别处提醒我们的，你若将别的居首位，必发现就是传道者某程度也会变成为流浪者。

让我从另一方面来说。这人不单渴慕神本身，除了神他一无爱慕。这是排他的爱慕。你从来有否期望在天上？这不是病态。我喜爱亨利·马太所写的：「圣经从来没有告诉我们说我们该期待死亡，但经常告诉我们的是我们该期待上天。」期待死亡的人不过因着他

man who looks forward to death simply wants to get out of life because of his troubles. This is not Christian; that is pagan. The Christian has a positive desire for heaven, and therefore I ask: Do we look forward to being in heaven? What is it we are desiring? Is it the rest of heaven? Is it to be free from trouble and tribulations? Is it the peace of heaven? Is it the joy of heaven? All those things are to be found there, thank God; but that is not the thing to look forward to in heaven. It is the face of God. 'Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God.' The Vision Splendid, the *Summum Bonum*, to stand in the very presence of God—'To gaze and gaze on Thee'. Do we long for that? Is that heaven to us? Is that the thing we want above everything else? It is the thing to covet and to long for.

The apostle Paul tells us that to die is 'to be with Christ'. There is no need to add anything to that. That is why, I believe, we are told so little in a detailed sense about the life in heaven and in glory. People often ask why we are not told more about it. I think there are two answers to that. One is that because of our sinful state any description we might be given would

的困难而想结束生命，这不是基督徒，这是异教徒。基督徒对天堂有着正意的渴望，因此我问：我们是否期待上天？我们正渴慕甚么？是否天上的安息？是否免于困难和灾难？是否天上的平安？是否天上的喜乐？感谢神，这一切都可在那儿找得到。但在天上所渴慕的东西不是这个，而是神的面。「清心的人有福了，因为他们必得见神。」（太5:8）壮丽的得见，站在神的面前，「注视又注视祢。」我们是否渴望这个？这于我们是否天堂？我们所渴望超乎一切的是否这个？这是你要渴求和渴想的。

使徒保罗说死就是「与基督在一起」。在这无需添加。我相信就是这原因我们为何那么少听到在天上和荣耀中生命的详细情况。人们常问为甚么不多告诉我们这个。有两个答案。一是因着我们的罪性，任何可能给与我们的描述都为我们所

be misunderstood by us. It is so glorious that we can neither understand nor grasp it. The second reason is more important; it is that it is often idle curiosity that desires to know more. I will tell you what heaven is. It is 'to be with Christ'. 'To be with Christ' is more than enough, it is everything.

This is how our Lord puts it in Luke 14:26, 'If any man come to me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple.' Do not worry about that word 'hate'; it is simply a strong word which makes it clear that any man who puts anyone or anything in his life before Christ is not a true disciple of His. To be a true disciple of Christ means that Christ is at the centre, Christ is the Lord of my life, Christ is on the throne of my being; it means that I love Him first before everyone and everything. 'None upon earth that I desire beside thee.' Does He come first in our lives? Even before our loved ones and our nearest and dearest? Even before our work, before our success, before our business, before anything else while we are here on earth? He should be

误解。死那么荣耀，我们既不能明白，也不能掌握；第二个原因更重要。渴慕认识更多常叫人不再好奇。我要告诉你天堂是「与基督同在」。「与基督一起」比足够更多，这是一切。

主在路14:26也这样说：「人到我这里来，若不恨自己的父母、妻子、儿女、弟兄、姐妹、和自己的性命，就不能作我的门徒。」不要为「恨」这个字来担忧，这只是一个重语气的字，所弄清的是任何将他生命中任何人或事放在基督前面的人不是祂的真门徒。作基督的真门徒是说到基督才是中心，是我生命之主，祂坐在我所是的宝座上；这说到我爱祂多于任何人和事。「在地上我也没有所爱慕的。」祂在我们生命上是否居首位？甚至是先于我们所爱，最亲近和最珍爱的人？先于我们的工作、成功、事业、在地上这里的任何东西？祂该是我们至高的

our supreme desire. 'To me to live ...' is what? 'is Christ,' says St. Paul. It is to be walking through this world with Christ Himself, to be having fellowship with Him in this life. And because this was true of him, he could also say that he had learned 'in whatsoever state I am, therewith to be content'. Why? Other things no longer control him. It is Christ, it is Christ alone he wants. If I have Christ, he says, I have all and 'I can do all things through Christ which strengtheneth me' (Philippians 4:11, 13). We are independent of circumstances and surroundings when living on Him and by Him and for Him, and all other things pale into insignificance.

'Whom have I in heaven but thee? and there is none upon earth that I desire beside thee. My flesh and my heart faileth: but God is the strength of my heart, and my portion for ever.' His portion, that is it; his supply, his satisfaction, his everything. There is nothing that he can desire but God. And what is God? He is Sun and Shield, He gives grace and glory.

That brings us to the last point, which is that the Psalmist rests confidently in God. He desires God for Himself, for His own sake rather than

渴望。保罗说于他来说，活着就是基督。与基督一起走经这世，今生与祂相交。因着这于他真确，他也能说「我无论在甚么景况都可以知足，这是我已经学会了。」（腓4:11）为甚么？别的事情不再控制他。独有基督是他想望的。他说到若他有着基督便有着一切，并且「我靠着那加给我力量的，凡事都能作。」（腓4:13）当我们靠祂，藉祂和因祂而活时，我们便自主于环境和周遭，所有其它的都变得淡然无价值。

「除祢以外，在天上我有谁呢？除祢以外，在地上我也没有所爱慕的。我的肉体，和我的心肠衰残。但神是我心里的力量，又是我的福分，直到永远。」（诗73:25-26）他的分就是他的供应、满足、一切。他所爱慕的没有别的，惟有神。

这领我们来到最后一点，就是诗人确信地安息于神。他爱慕神本身，因着祂而不是因着祂所

for what He gives. He desires nothing but God. He finds complete satisfaction in God, and he rests and reposes confidently in Him. Listen to him, 'My flesh and my heart faileth: but God is the strength of my heart, and my portion for ever.' There are those who say that he is referring here not only to the time when his flesh would decay through age, but also to something he was experiencing at the time. Probably they are right, because you cannot pass through a spiritual experience such as this man passed through without your physical body suffering. I believe this man's nerves were in a bad state. His physical heart may have been misbehaving itself. 'My flesh and my heart faileth.' He may have been in a bad state physically. But in any case, looking to the future, he knows there is a day coming when his flesh and his heart will fail. He will become an old man; his faculties will fail; his strength will falter; he will not be able to feed himself; he will be lying helpless in his bed; things of time and earth will be slipping away. 'It will still be all right,' says this man, 'for whatever may happen God, the same yesterday, today and for ever, will still be the strength of my heart.'

赐的。除了神之外他一无爱慕。他在神处找到完全的满足，他也确信地安息和信赖神。听听他：「我的肉体，和我的心肠衰残。但神是我心里的力量，又是我的福分，直到永远。」有人说到他这样说所指的不单止是年日流逝时他肉身会衰败，也是说到今时所经历的一些东西。也许他们是对的，因为你不能如同这人所经历的一个属灵经历而你的肉身是不用经受的。我相信这人的神经正处于一极差的状况。他的肉心可能失常。「我的肉体，和我的心肠衰残。」他可能处于身体差的状况中。无论如何，当他望向未来时，他是知道他的肉体 and 心肠终有一日会衰残的。他必会衰老，机能衰退，力量退减，他会不能再喂养自己，他会无助地卧在床上，时日 and 地上之物会流逝。这人说：「但万事仍然安妥，因为无论发生何事，那昨天、今天和永远不变的神仍是我心的力量。」

It is generally agreed that the word which is translated 'strength' is the word 'rock'. 'But God is the Rock of my heart, and my portion for ever.' I rather like that, because it conjures up an image in our minds. 'O, yes,' says this man, 'I know that I am in such a position that I can rest quietly and confidently in Him. I know that I can say that, even though a day may come when I shall feel the foundations of life shaking beneath me, God will be a rock that will hold me. He cannot be moved; He cannot be shaken. He is the Rock of ages, and whatever I am, and whatever may be happening, however my physical frame is behaving, and even when the things of earth are passing away, God the Rock will sustain me and I shall never be moved. 'God is the Rock, the strength, of my heart, and my portion for ever.'

The Bible is never tired of saying this. Read what others say. Whatever terrible conditions may come to pass, this is the comfort and consolation that they all give. Not only is God a Rock but 'underneath are the everlasting arms'. Your foundations in life may be gone, everything you built on may be crashing down and you yourself going down into the abyss.

普遍同意译作「力量」一词本是「盘石」。「但神是我心里的盘石，又是我的福分，直到永远。」我较喜欢这个，因这在我心中引发一个形像。这人说：「噢，是的，我知道我是在能够安然和信靠地安息在祂里头这位分上。我知我可这样说，那怕我感到生命根基在我以下摇动那日终于来到时，神必会是扶持我的盘石。我不被移动，不至动摇。祂是万古盘石，无论我在那里，有甚么事情发生，无论我肉身有何表现，甚或地上事物都逝去，盘石之神必会维持我，我必不动摇。」神是我心的盘石和力量，是我永远的分。」

圣经在说到这个上永不言倦。读读别人所说。无论状况如何可怖，他们得赐的是愉快和安慰。神不单是盘石，「祂永久的膀臂在你以下。」（申33:27）你生命的根基也许不再，在上面建造的也许倒塌，自己也正往阴间而去。不。「在你以

But, no; 'underneath'—and they are always there—'underneath are the everlasting arms'. They are always holding you; you will never finally crash; you will be held when everything else is gone. Listen to Isaiah stating the same thing. He talks about that 'foundation stone'; that 'tried stone ... a sure foundations' that has been set, and what he says is, 'He that believeth shall not make haste.' A better translation is that given in the New Testament, 'He that believeth on him shall not be confounded.' Or according to another possible translation, 'He that believeth shall never be put to shame.' Why not? He is on the Rock, he has this support, he has this foundation, and it cannot be moved, for it is God Himself. And on this Rock, though my flesh and my heart may fail, I shall never be moved, I shall never be taken by surprise, I shall never be put to shame. God will see me right through.

Chapter XI The New Resolution

For, lo, they that are far from thee shall perish: thou hast destroyed all them that go a whoring from thee. But it is good for me to draw near to God: I have put my trust in the Lord God, that

下」,双臂总在那里,「祂永久的膀臂在你以下。」他们总托起你,你永不会失败告终,就算万事都过去,你却必会被维持。以赛亚谈到作为根基的石头,所立的是那「试验过的石头,是稳固根基」(赛28:16)。「信靠的人必不着急。」在新约有一个更好的翻译,「信靠祂的人必不至于混乱。」(彼前2:6)另一个译本说到:「信靠祂的人必永不羞愧。」不羞愧是因为他在盘石上,他得着其支撑,这根基不能移动,这是神本身。我的肉体和心肠虽衰残,但在这盘石上的我必永不移动,永不被突如其来的事情逮住,落在羞辱中。神必领我经过。

十一 新的决心

「远离祢的,必要死亡。凡离弃祢行邪淫的,祢都灭绝了。但我亲近神是与我有益。我以主耶和华为我的避难所,好叫我

I may declare all thy works.

Let us begin by looking at the actual resolution which the Psalmist had formed. Here it is again in the Authorized Version, 'But it is good for me to draw near to God.' Another translation could be this, 'But as for myself, nearness to God is good for me.' He is contrasting himself with others. Whatever may be true about them, it is nearness to God that is good for him. His chief ambition is going to be just that, to keep near to God. He helps us to see the importance of this resolution by putting it in the form of a contrast. 'For, lo,' he says, 'they that are far from thee shall perish: ... but it is good for me to draw near to God.' There are only these two positions in this life. We are all either far from God or near to Him. And there is no other possible position, so that it is vitally important that we should arrive at this man's resolve, to be near to God.

Reviewing his sad experience he came to the conclusion that what had really been wrong with him, and what had accounted for all his trouble, was just the fact that he did not keep near to God. He had thought it was the fact

述说祢一切的作为。(诗 73:27-28)

让我们先来看看诗人已作的实在决心。再一次来到修定本：「亲近神是与我有益。」另一个译本可以是这样的：「但于我自己来说，亲近神于我有益。」他是将他自己与别人作比对。无论别人如何真确，亲近神于他有益。他的主要志向就是要公义，要保持与神亲近。他将此决定写成对比的形式来帮助我们得见这决定的重要性。他说：「看哪，远离祢的他们必定灭亡；但亲近神于我有益。」在今世只有这两个地位。我们全都远离神或亲近祂。再没有别些可能的地位了，因此我们该达至这人要亲近神的决定是至关重要的。

检视他糟透的经历时，他下了一个结论，就是真的苦待他的，并他一切困苦的原因，只不过是他不持守来亲近神这事实吧了。他曾以为事实是

that the ungodly seemed to prosper while he experienced nothing but troubles. But now, having been given the enlightenment which he had in the sanctuary of God, he sees quite clearly that this was not the root cause of his trouble at all. There is only one thing that matters and that is man's relationship to God. If I am near to God, says this man, it does not really matter what happens to me; but if I am far from God, nothing can eventually be right. And this is the very profound conclusion to which he came.

One good reason for keeping near to God is the contemplation of the fate of those who do not do so. He puts that first, you notice, and I think that he does so because he is still, in a sense, thinking experimentally. It was these ungodly people who really had led him astray. He is anxious, therefore, to safeguard himself against falling into that trap again. He knows, as he comes to face the future, that the world is not going to change. The ungodly will still be as they have always been, their eyes 'standing out with fatness'. Everything may be marvelous and wonderful for them. But he is never again going to fall into

不信神之人的似乎兴盛而他经历不来兴盛却只有困苦。但他在进入神的圣所，得赐下亮光下，如今他十分清晰得见这完全不是他困苦的根本原因。只有一事是要紧的，这就是人与神的关系。那人说：我若亲近神时，发生在我身上的事便真的不打紧了；我若远离神时，最终没有东西会正确的了。这正是他达至的深奥结论。

保持亲近神的一个美好原因就是想到不这样作之人的结局。你留意到他将这放在首位，我想这是因为他在某程度上仍然凭经验来思想。其实是这些不信神之人使他走迷。因此他切望来保守自己不至再掉进那陷阱。当他面对未来时，他知道世界不会改变。不信神的人必一如既往，他们的眼睛因体胖而凸出。（诗73:7）事事于他们来说可能是不可思议和奇异的。但他永不再掉进陷阱中。因此他将这放在首位。他说：

the trap. So he puts it first. 'Lo,' he says, 'they that are far from thee shall perish: thou hast destroyed all them that go a whoring from thee.' God has done it in the past, He will do it in the future.

Now we have been through all this in detail. The Psalmist has dealt with it at length. 'Surely thou didst set them in slippery places: thou castedst them down into destruction. How are they brought into desolation, as in a moment! they are utterly consumed with terrors.' 'Then understood I their end'! That is just a summary of history. That is the whole story of the world before the Flood and after, the whole story of Sodom and Gomorrah and similar events in history. What a fool Abraham seemed, wandering among the mountains with his sheep, in contrast with Lot's prosperous situation in the cities of the plain, with their vice and immorality. Well might he have asked: Does it pay to be godly? 'But lo,' he also might have said, 'they that are far from thee shall perish: thou hast destroyed all them that go a whoring from thee.' That is the long story of Old Testament history put here very plainly, 'They that are far from thee shall perish.'

「看哪，远离祢的，必要死亡。凡离弃祢行邪淫的，祢都灭绝了。」(诗73:27) 神过去这样，将来也必这样。

如今我们已详细察看这一切。诗人已充分处理这个。「祢实在把他们安在滑地，使他们掉在沉沦之中。他们转眼之间，成了何等的荒凉。他们被惊恐灭尽了。」(诗73:18-19)「等我.....思想他们的结局！」(诗73:17) 这只是历史的记要。这是洪水前后世界的整体故事，所多玛和蛾摩拉并历史上相似事件的整体故事。亚伯拉罕何等愚蠢，与群羊在山间游荡，相对于罗得在城市平原的昌盛情况，连同罪恶和不道德。他也许会问：「虔诚有否回报？他也许会说：但是看哪，「远离祢的，必要死亡。凡离弃祢行邪淫的，祢都灭绝了。」这是将长长旧约历史的故事坦白地写出来，「远离祢的，必要死亡。」

But the second reason is more positive. Here, this man puts it in terms of the character of God. 'It is good for me to draw near to God: I have put my trust in the Lord God.' He has resolved to be near to God and to live his life as near to God as possible. Why? Because God is good, because of the character of God.

There is yet a further reason here. 'It is good for me,' he says; 'nearness to God is good for me.' It was 'for the joy that was set before him' that our blessed Lord 'endured the cross'; and is not this what the apostle means when he says, 'I reckon that the sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory which shall be revealed in us' (Romans 8:18)? Put these things in the right order. Start with God as God, and because He is God, and then remember that He is God for you. In other words, it means that being near to God is the place of salvation. And that is why the Psalmist wants to remain there. It is not surprising that he says that it is good for him to draw near to God in view of the experience he had gone through. You remember his misery and wretchedness and how it was too painful for him until he went

而第二个原因是更正面的。这人在这里以神的性情来说：「但我亲近神是与我有益。(我已信靠主神。)」他已决意亲近神，活尽量亲近神的生命。为甚么？因着神是美善的，这本是神的性情。

这里还另有一个原因。他说：「这于我有益，亲近神于我有益。」我们的恩主「因那摆在前面的喜乐就忍受了十字架。」(来12:2)这不就是使徒所说的「我想现在的苦楚，若比起将来要显于我们的荣耀，就不足介意了。」(罗8:18)将这些东西按正确次序排列。先以神为神，因为祂就是神，之后谨记祂是你的神。换句话说，这是说到与神亲近就是得恩之所。就是这原因为何诗人想停留在那儿。得见他所曾经历的而听到他说亲近神是与他有益的便不足为奇了。你还记得他的痛苦和悲惨，并这如何叫他痛不欲生，直至他来到神的圣所。当他在那里明白

into the sanctuary of God. But there, having understood the position, his happiness came flooding back to him. He rejoiced in God, and he felt that he had never been so happy in the whole of his life, though the circumstances of the ungodly were still the same. It is good to keep near to God; it is the place of salvation and deliverance.

James in his practical manner puts this very simply in his Epistle. 'Draw nigh to God,' he says, 'and he will draw nigh to you' (James 4:8). This, again, is a glorious thought, and we can be certain that every time we take a step in the direction of God—if I may speak thus—God will take a step in our direction. Do not imagine when you consider drawing near to God that you will find it difficult. If we approach Him truly, if we approach Him honestly, we can always be certain that God will meet us. He is the God of salvation. That is a very good reason for drawing near to Him. He has every blessing that we need. There is nothing we can ever stand in need of but God has it. All blessings come from God; He is the Giver of 'every good gift and every perfect gift'. He has put them all in Christ, and He has given us Christ. 'All things are yours,' says Paul

到他的处境时，他的快乐实时涌回他处。他在神里头欢欣，他也感觉到他人一生中从未曾这样快乐过，虽然不信神之人的处境仍一样。常亲近神有益，那里是得救和得释放之所。

雅各布以其实际态度简明地将这记在书信中。「你们亲近神，神就必亲近你们。」（雅4:8）这也是荣耀的思想，我们可肯定每次我们往神走近一步，容我说神也必会往我们走近一步。不要以为当你走近神时会感到困难。我们若真诚来就近祂，诚实来就近祂，总能肯定神必会迎见我们。神是拯救的神，这是亲近祂的十分好原因。祂有着我们所需的每个恩福。我们所逼切需要的东西惟有神拥有。所有恩福从神而来。祂赐下「各样美善的恩赐和各样全备的赏赐」（雅1:17），祂将一切放在基督里，且将基督给与我们。保罗说「万有全是你们的」（林前3:21），

to the Corinthians. Why? Because 'ye are Christ's'. It is an inevitable piece of logic. It is good for me to draw near to God because when I am near to God I know my sins are forgiven; but when I am far from God I begin to doubt it. I cannot deal with a guilty conscience. I can deal still less with the accusations of other people, or of the devil. It is only when I am near to God in Christ that I know my sins are forgiven. I feel His live, I know I am His child and I enjoy the priceless blessings of peace with God and peace within and peace with others. I am aware of His love and I am given a joy that the world can neither give nor take away.

Anyone who has ever tasted of these things must say that there is nothing comparable to being near to God. Look back across your life. Pick out the most glorious moments in your experience, the moments of supreme peace and joy. Have they not been the times when you have been nearest to God? There is nothing to equal the happiness and joy and peace which result from being near to God. There you are lifted up above your circumstances. You begin to know something of what Paul meant when he said, 'I have learned, in whatsoever

因「你们是属基督的。」(林前3:23)这是必然的逻辑。亲近神与我有益是因我亲近神便知我的罪得恕;远离神时便在罪上存疑。我不能处理犯罪的良心。在面对别人甚或魔鬼的控诉时我尚且不能应付,惟有我亲近在基督里的神时,我才知我的罪得恕。我感到祂活,我知我是祂的儿女,并得享与神平安、内里平安和与他平安的无价恩福。我察觉祂的爱,得赐世界从不能给与和取走的喜乐。

任何未曾尝过这些东西的人一定说没有东西可与亲近神相比的。回望你的一生,选取你经历过最辉煌的时刻,最大平安和喜乐的时刻。这不就是你最亲近神的时刻么?没有东西能与亲近神而来的喜乐和平安相比的。那时你被提升超越你的环境。你开始认识到保罗所说的:「我无论在甚么景况都可以知足,这是我已经学会了。我知道怎样处卑贱,也知道怎样

state I am, therewith to be content,' 'I know both how to be abased, and I know how to abound.' You are made independent of circumstances and accident and chance, independent of all things. It is good to be near to God because it is the place of salvation, because it is the place where you experience all the blessings. It means that you are immersed in the ocean of God's love and are staying there. Let us adopt this man's resolve to keep near to God.

'The name of the Lord is a strong tower: the righteous runneth into it, and is safe' (Proverbs 18:10). A man is outside in the world and the enemy begins to attack him. He cannot deal with him; he does not know what to do; he is alarmed and terrified. Then he runs into the strong tower, the name of the Lord, this Lord Jehovah. The enemy cannot get in there. In the arms of God, these almighty arms, he is safe. Yes, says the apostle John, 'we know that we are of God, and the whole world lieth in the evil one,' and 'that evil one cannot touch us' (see 1 John 5:19, 18). Why not? Because we are in Christ, we are in God. We are perfectly safe there. Let me quote again one of the grandest things the

处丰富。」(腓4:11-12) 你是独立于环境、意外和机遇，独立于一切的。亲近神有益是因着这是救恩之地，因为这是你能经历所有恩福之处。这意味着你沉潜和停留在神爱的海洋中。让我们采用这人的决志来保持亲近神。

「耶和華的名，是堅固台；義人奔入，便得安穩。」(箴18:10) 當人暴露在世時，敵人便開始攻擊他。他不能應付。他不知有何可作，他驚恐和害怕。之後他跑向主名耶和華那堅固台，仇敵不能進來。在神的大能膀臂中，他是安全的。使徒約翰說：「是的，我們知道我們是屬神的，全世界都卧在那惡者手下。」並且「那惡者也就無法害他。」(約壹5:19, 18) 為何不能？因我們在基督里，在神里头，我們在那里完全安全。讓我再次引述使徒保羅曾說到其

apostle Paul ever said: 'I am persuaded (he is certain), that neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor powers, nor things present, nor things to come, nor height, nor depth, nor any other creature, shall be able to separate us from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus our Lord' (Romans 8:38, 39). Safe in the arms of Jesus. If you are there, though hell be let loose it cannot touch you. Nothing can harm those who are in the safe keeping of their covenant-keeping God.

The last thing the Psalmist mentions is again very wonderful. Let me just note it. 'It is good for me to draw near to God: I have put my trust in the Lord God, that I may declare all thy works.' Now this is a very vital addition. This is the point at which we should all arrive. His final reason for determining to keep near to God is in order that he might glorify God, in order that he might declare all His works.

Thus we have looked at this man's resolve, and we have looked at his reasons for making it. May I remind you, briefly, how all this is to be done? Is it not enough to say, Keep near to God, and if you do so these things will

中一件最大的事情，「因为我深信无论是死，是生，是天使，是掌权的，是有能的，是现在的事，是将来的事，是高大的，是低处的，是别的受造之物，都不能叫我们与神的爱隔绝。这爱是在我们的主基督耶稣里的。」任由活动的地狱不能触碰在在耶稣膀臂中安稳的你。没有东西能伤害被守约之神所保护的人。

诗人再次十分奇妙地说到最后的一件事。

「亲近神与我有益：我已将我的信靠放在主神身上，因此我得以宣告祂一切的工作。」这是十分关键的补充。我们全都可以达至这个。他决意保持亲近神的最终原因是为了他得以荣耀神，得以宣告祂一切的工作。

因此我们看见了这人的决心，也看见他这样作的原因。让我来稍为提醒你，这一切如何作成？说常亲近神是不足够的，你若也这样作，这些也会

happen. How do I keep near to God? We must get down to the practical level. You and I as Christians know that we can always draw near to God in Jesus Christ. We need not scale the heights or descend to the depths. 'The word is nigh thee, even in thy mouth, and in thy heart: ... that if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved' (Romans 10:8, 9). We need not worry about this because, if we are Christian at all, we know that, however much we may have sinned, however much wrong we may have done to others and to ourselves, if at this moment we come to God and confess our sins, admitting that we cannot undo them or save ourselves, and trusting entirely in the Son of God and what He has done on our behalf, by His life of obedience and His sacrificial saving death, we are accepted of God, we are reconciled to God, we are in communion with God. That is the way. Yes, but remember to keep near to God. That is this man's resolve. How are we to do it? First of all by a life of prayer. I must insist upon this. If I believe all I have been saying, then I believe that I can talk to

发生。我如何能常亲近神？我们定须落到实际的层面。作为基督徒的你我都知道我们总能在耶稣基督里亲近神。我们不用升上天上或降到阴间去，「这道离你不远，正在你口里，在你心里。.....你若口里认耶稣为主，心里信神叫祂从死里复活，就必得救。」(罗10:8-9)我们不用担心这个，因为我们已是基督徒，我们知道，无论我们犯了多少罪，对别人和自己作了多少的错事，若在这刻我们来到神处，来承认我们的罪，承认我们不能除掉他们，不能自救，完全信靠神的儿子并祂为我们缘故所作的一切，就是藉着祂顺服的生命和祂能救赎的牺牲死亡所作的，那么我们是为神所悦纳，与神和好，与神相交。方法就是这样。谨记常亲近神，这是那人的决意。我们如何这样决意？首要的是祷告的生命。我定须在此坚持。我若相信一切我曾说的，那么我相信我能与神说话了。我若真的

God. If I realize truly who He is, I shall want to talk to Him. The man who really keeps near to God is the man who is always talking to God. We must resolve to do this; we must decide that we will not allow the world to control us any longer, but that we are going to control it, and our time, and our energy and everything else.

Then in addition to prayer, there is Bible reading. In this Book God speaks to you. Therefore read and study the Scriptures.

Next comes public worship. It was when he went into the sanctuary of God that this man found peace and rest for his soul. And we have often had the same experience. If we want to keep near to God, we must not only pray in private, but also with others, we must not only read and study the Word in private but also come and do so with others. We help one another, we bear one another's burdens.

Then there is meditation and taking time to think. Throw the newspaper on one side and think about God and about your soul and about all these things. We do not talk enough to ourselves. We must tell ourselves that we are in His presence, that we are His children, that Christ

明白祂是谁，我必想跟祂说话。那真的常亲近神的人是常与神交谈的人。我们定须决意这样作，我们定须立志，我们必不再容许世界来在任何地方操控我们，我们的时间和精力。

除了祷告之外，还要加上读经。神会在这书上来跟你说话，因此翻读和研究圣经吧。

之后是公开敬拜。这人就在他进入神的圣所时，为他的灵魂找到平静和安息。我们也常有这经历。我们若想常亲近神，必须不单止有私祷，也要与别人一起祷告，我们必须不单止个人翻读和研习圣经，也要来与他人一起作。我们彼此帮助，我们背负彼此的担子。

之后是默想，花时间去思想。把报纸放在一旁，想想神，想想你的灵魂，想想所有这些事。我们跟自己说话不够，必须告诉自己我们是在祂的同在中，我们是祂的儿女。基督为我们死，并叫

has died for us and that He has reconciled us to God. We must practice the presence of God, and realize it, we must talk to Him, and spend our days with Him. That is the method. To draw near to God means to seek Him, and never to allow ourselves any peace or rest until we know that our sins are forgiven, until we know God, until we know the love of God, until we are conscious that when we pray He is ready to listen.

The final thing, of course, is obedience, because if we disobey Him we break contact. Sin always means a breaking of the connection, it means going far away from God. So the two rules are, to see God and then to obey Him. And if we should sin, so breaking the contact and communion, we immediately re-establish it by confessing our sins, knowing that 'the blood of Jesus Christ his Son' cleanses us from all unrighteousness.

God grant that as we face the future this may be our heartfelt resolve—'For me, nearness to God is good for me.' May we know Him and dwell with Him and spend the remainder of our days really basking in the sunshine of His face and enjoying blessed fellowship with Him.

我们与神和好。我们必须习练神的同在，明白它，我们须跟祂说话，终日跟祂一起。方法就是这样。亲近神就是寻求祂，不要容许一己有任何平静安稳，直至我们知道我们的罪已被赦免，直至我们认识神，认识神的爱，直至当我们祷告时，我们觉知祂已预备好来垂听了。

最后的当然是顺服了，因为我们若不顺服祂的话，我们便打断了接触。罪总有打破连系的意味，也意味着远离神。因此法则是：得见神，之后是顺服祂。我们若犯罪，便打破了接触与相交；我们是藉着承认我们的罪，认识到祂儿子耶稣基督的血洁净我们所有的不义下来立时得重建的。

当我们面对未来时，神恩赐「但我亲近神是与我有益」作为我们衷心的决志。但愿我们认识祂，与祂同住，将我们余下的日子真的敞照在祂的面光中，得享祂赐恩的团契。

Faith on Trial

试炼中的信心

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《试炼中的信心》

我们跟诗 73 篇的诗人无异，为着恶人和狂傲人享平安而心怀不平，几乎跌倒。「神实在恩待以色列那些清心的人。至于我，我的脚几乎失闪，我的脚险些滑跌。」(诗 73:1-2)

作者藉他的心路历程来解明神的心肠和旨意。神逐步来光照，叫我们明白我们对神的误解，和照明我们的本相。

神的恩显在「我思索怎能明白这事，眼看实系为难。等我进了神的圣所，思想他们的结局。」(诗 73:16-17) 上。是神隐隐呼召我们来进祂的圣所，来谱写整篇诗篇，展示神的眷顾和爱护。